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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Thursday, 6th November, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 2:36 p.m.*

[FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER, MR
BERNARD AHIAFOR,
IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, without much ado, can we move straight to take item numbered 5, in the absence of Message from the President and Communication by the Speaker? Item numbered 5 on the *Order Paper* — Correction of Votes and Proceedings and the *Official Report*. Hon Members, we have the *Votes and Proceedings* of Wednesday, 5th November, 2025, under correction.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS
AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, page 1...9—

Yes, Mr Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much. With respect, may I kindly draw your attention to the item numbered 9. It is just a minor but an important correction. They have captured two Statements and I think that

the heading should reflect the plural form of what is written at the top. So, the heading is “STATEMENT”, meanwhile, two different Statements have been captured under it. So, if they could delete the “STATEMENT” and insert “STATEMENTS”.

Mr Speaker, again, on a minor note, I am aware that the Hon Member for Ashaiman now holds a doctorate degree but I do not know if he has done the needful by writing to the Clerks-at-the-Table anyway. If he has done that, then it should be captured as such.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, I think there was an issue like that raised in the first week. The practice and procedure is that, when you attain that level, you should officially write to the Table Office, indicating that you want to be addressed as such or be attached to your name. So, if he has not written to them, then the name is correct the way it is. He is not here to prove that he has written to them to that effect.

Yes?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think my Colleague should be guided by what you said. Early on, the Rt Hon Speaker ruled that there is procedure that one needs to follow to capture one’s right title: whether you are an Alhaji, a Dr or Professor. Considering the fact that there are a lot of fake doctorate degree holders in the system now, Members need to officially write to the Table Office, so that they can have Members on record

that, that is their right titles. So that, if there is a backlash somewhere, we would know. Because there are so many fake titles, doctorate degree holders and professors in the system. Parliament will not just entertain persons just saying that they hold a doctorate degree or are professors and just admit it like that. They should do the right thing by writing. Then we will have it that the Hon Member has written to be addressed that way and attached all the documents to show that. We do not want Ghana Tertiary Education Commission (GTEC) saying that some Members of Parliament are doctorate degree holders and professors while they are not. We would definitely not entertain any fake doctorate degree holder or professor in the Chamber of Parliament.

Mr Speaker, the right thing needs to be done. So, they should take a cue.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I believe this is not an issue calling for debate. What do you have to say?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I think on any day and any time, I am prepared to learn from my Senior. But I think I was so categorical and clear that I was not too sure if the Member has written to alert the Clerks-at-the-Table. So, the procedure is very well known to this Member—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, this should not be a matter. Hon Member, next time to raise an issue on the floor of Parliament, you must be sure.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I am guided.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Regarding the plural form of the item numbered 9, the Table Office should take note and add the letter “S”.

Page 10—

Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, sorry that you are making progress and I want to draw us back on the matter raised by Mr Frank Afriyie and commented on by the First Deputy Minority Whip.

Mr Speaker, I remember when the issue regarding the title of Prof Seidu Alidu Mahama was raised, the direction was that he has to write— Looking at our procedures, if at the time the person was filling the documents regarding their credentials, it was captured, then there is no need for the person to write again because the documents have them.

However, if a Member’s credentials or status changes while they are in the House, then the Member needs to write for their records to be updated. For example, if a Member enters this Chamber as a doctorate degree holder or professor, the title is supposed to be on your file, unless it is not there. But in the process, if any additional credential or status changes or happens, then that Member has to officially write for the records to be updated.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Owusu-Akyaw: No, please.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. It is the same thing that was said.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Then, kindly resume your seat.

Page 10?

Mr Owusu-Akyaw: Mr Speaker, there is an error. I am a member of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources.

Mr Francis Kwabena Berepong Owusu-Akyaw: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

On page 9, the item numbered 10(b), it reads:

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, kindly resume your seat. The *Votes and Proceedings* captured what happened on the floor of this House. So, once you were not here yesterday, it will be difficult for you to establish that whatever is here was the referral actually made by the First Deputy Speaker. That is why I am asking you to humbly resume your seat.

“The Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of Ghana Geological Survey Authority for the year 2024.”

Mr Speaker, Geological Survey is not under the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovation, it is rather under the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources.

Thank you very much. Pages 10 and 11?

But I can see that they have inculcated it into the Ministry of –

Hon Members, in the absence of any further correction, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Wednesday, 5th November, 2025 is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

2:46 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What is the correction you are making?

Hon Members, the *Official Reports* of 28th October, 2025 and 29th October, 2025. We shall first correct the *Official Report* of 28th October, 2025. It is for your correction?

Mr Owusu-Akyaw: The correction I am making is that the annual statement by the Audit Committee of Ghana Geological Survey Authority for the year 2024 should be under c(iii) –

Yes, Hon Member for Kwadaso.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, were you here yesterday?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I thought you said 29th October because I have an issue on that date.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, we will soon come to 29th but now, 28th is under correction.

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Tuesday, 28th October, 2025]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now, the *Official Report* of Wednesday, 29th October, 2025.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I think I have to drop the observation. I am fine. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Any corrections?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Wednesday, 29th October, 2025]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the next item is the item numbered 6 which is an Urgent Question standing in the name of Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh, Member of Parliament for Bosome Freho.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

Mr Ayariga — rose —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Acting Minister for Defence, as you know, is also the Minister for Finance and because of the ongoing work on the

Budget, he is very constrained. So, his deputy is here, the Deputy Minister for Defence. I would want to crave your indulgence to grant leave for the Deputy Minister to answer the Question. I discussed it earlier with Alhaji Habib Iddrisu and Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib and they agreed not to raise any objections, so you may not need to ask for their opinion, whether they accept or not, because we have already agreed. They know I will not lie to you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Having regard that you will not lie to me, I will still have to hear from them.

Yes, Hon First Deputy Minority Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader is my senior Brother so sometimes when he comes from different angles, I find it very difficult to object. Even though he has not given us substantial reasons regarding the whereabouts of the Acting Minister, we had some chats. However, even the Standing Orders have given the discretion to you on that because Order 88(6) reads:

“In the absence of the Minister, Member or the Head of the Independent Constitutional Body to whom a Question is directed, the Speaker may permit an authorised person to respond to the Question.”

Mr Speaker, so we are entirely in your hands. Except that I do not know whether the Deputy Minister is well equipped or has the capacity to respond

to this Question and other supplementary questions. So, if the Majority Leader is actually requesting the Deputy Minister to respond, it should not be the case that he will answer the substantive Question and then may run away from the supplementary questions that might follow.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, it is always in line with natural justice to listen to both parties in order to enable you to exercise the discretion effectively. So having heard from you that you are not opposed to the Deputy Minister answering the Question, I would then ask the Deputy Minister to take the appropriate seat for the questioner to pose the Question.

Yes, Hon Member for Bosome Freho, you have the floor.

Mr Ayeh: Thank you, Mr Speaker. My condolences to the entire nation. When I was filing this Question, I had the Minister who is demised in mind. My condolences to the nation, party and his good family.

URGENT QUESTION

MINISTRY OF DEFENCE

Measures Taken to Ensure the Safety of Officers and Citizens of Ghana in the Midst of Political Instability in Togo

Mr Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh (NPP — Bosome Freho): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Defence what measures the Ministry is taking to ensure

the territorial integrity, security of officers and citizens of Ghana in the midst of the recent political instability in Togo.

Deputy Minister for Defence (Mr Ernest Brogya Genfi) on behalf of the Ag. Minister for Defence: Thank you, Mr Speaker. The recent situation in Togo, if escalated, poses potential security, social and economic risks to Ghana, including refugee inflows, cross-border crimes and other destabilising effects. The Ministry of Defence, working closely with other security and intelligence agencies, has therefore adopted a comprehensive contingency framework to pre-empt and respond to any adverse effects of these risks. This framework, I must emphasise, is preventive, proactive and multidimensional in nature and seeks to uphold the peace and security of our dear nation.

Mr Speaker, in furtherance to this objective, the Ghana Armed Forces, in collaboration with other security and intelligence agencies, has taken the following measures:

Securing the eastern frontier. In addition to existing security arrangements along the Ghana-Togo Border, joint patrols have been intensified, particularly along porous and unapproved routes, to deter infiltration, prevent territorial encroachment and assure the Ghanaian public of their safety.

2:56 p.m.

On humanitarian preparedness and civil-military co-operation, the Ministry

intends to pre-position humanitarian logistics at designated reception centres such as Aflao, Denu and Kpetoe to manage potential refugee inflows.

Additionally, the Ghana Armed Forces Coordination Teams will work with the National Disaster Management Organisation (NADMO) and the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR), as well as other partners, to ensure that displaced persons are registered, screened and cared for in accordance with humanitarian standards. This process, besides providing care and assistance, would further help to identify, prevent and arrest potential troublemakers. Mr Speaker, the Ministry has issued firm but measured instructions to our troops to exercise maximum restraint and engage only in the event of a direct and imminent threat.

The Ghana Armed Forces has initiated strategic communication activities aimed at sensitising communities along the Eastern Corridor for the purpose and scope of our deployment, that is, enhancing civil-military trust and deterring misinformation. To ensure effectiveness of our communication activities, the communication and information operations have considered using local languages to deepen our operations.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Defence, through the Ghana Armed Forces, is fully committed to maintaining peace and stability within our borders, in line with its mission to safeguarding the sovereignty and dignity of our Republic.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Deputy Minister.

Hon Member, any supplementary questions?

Mr Ayeh: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Let me first and foremost acknowledge the all-encompassing approach with which the Hon Deputy Minister has responded to the Question. I want to get some specifics. What specific changes have been made to the Ghana Armed Forces operational deployments along the Eastern Corridor, including the rapid response task, surveillance, drones and forward operation bases, if we have any, and what are the current routes for engagement to the border and the post?

Thank you.

Mr Ayariga — *rose*—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I am sure the Hon Member knows that detailed operational issues of the Armed Forces cannot be disclosed in the Chamber of Parliament. How many drones they use, how many soldiers and where they are deployed, are detailed operational issues and that cannot be disclosed in the Chamber of Parliament.

Secondly, Mr Speaker, if you check our Standing Orders, we are required to be careful when it relates to a foreign country. Order 86 (1) (k) says a Questions shall not:

“refer discourteously to any country nor contain expressions that are likely to undermine the foreign relations between Ghana and another country”.

In this regard, a foreign country, our immediate neighbour, is involved, so we need to be careful the kind of questions we ask and how we refer to a foreign country. Should we even be debating the instability in their country? These are all matters that we should be careful about. But I think that a Question about the detailed operational issues of the Armed Forces should not be allowed by the Rt Hon Speaker.

Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I listened to the Hon Majority Leader, and with the greatest respect to him, I disagree with his intervention. He attempted to ground his intervention on Order 86 (1) (k), but he completely mixed the issues and missed the point.

The Hon Member’s supplementary question did not seek to refer discourteously to any country, neither could the Hon Majority Leader say that the question contains expressions that are likely to undermine the foreign relations between Ghana and any other country. That was not the mainstay of his question. The burden of the question was to get from the Hon Deputy Minister those operational activities and to give some breakdown. I mean, the Hon Deputy Minister can be general, but for the Hon Majority Leader to attempt to invoke Order 86 (1) (k) and by so doing invite you, Mr Speaker, to rule him out

of order, with the greatest of respect, it is not a fair approach.

The Hon Member has complied with the rule on supplementary questions. What he is asking is emanating from the main Answer from the Hon Deputy Minister. That is all his prayer. If the Hon Deputy Minister knew that those matters were sensitive and of national security in nature, then he should not have provided it in his Answer. The respected Hon Member, Mr Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh, is not introducing anything new. He is only asking a question based on what the Hon Deputy Minister at the despatch box has told the Parliament of Ghana.

So, Mr Speaker, with respect, the Hon Member is not out of order. He is within the rules. He has acted within the tenets of supplementary questions, and do not be inclined to this invitation.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I actually did not raise an objection to the question for some reason. But when you sit in the Parliament of Ghana and you describe the situation in Togo as “political instability”, you have in my opinion, discourteously referred to the situation of a foreign country. People are engaged in their demonstrations, and they have a right to demonstrate. Their government is managing the situation. The Hon Member was inviting this House to interfere in a matter involving a foreign country. I saw that, but I allowed it to

pass. The Hon Deputy Minister gave an Answer which the Hon Member admitted to be comprehensive enough and commended him for it. So, I thought that the matter would have ended there. Now the Hon Member is saying that the Hon Deputy Minister should now give a detailed operational activities of the Armed Forces.

3:06 p.m.

He asked for detailed operational activities of the soldiers, including how many drones and officers they are deploying and I am saying that when one gets to that level, one is asking for too much detail. Operational details of a deployment are not matters that the Minister should be telling us here in the Chamber. It does not happen anywhere. That is why I raised the objection.

I even showed him that the Question itself had difficulties, but we decided to ignore it and allow him to ask the Question. The Togolese Government can write to us asking why we are describing the situation in their country as political instability. Why are we interfering in the affairs of their country? They have a right to ask us. What is happening in Togo is the business of Togo. If one has evidence that a Ghanaian in any way has an issue, one can now ask the question about the condition of that Ghanaian. That is the context in which I make reference to that Order.

But my actual objection is to his asking for operational details of what the military is doing at the border. No, I do not think that the Minister should be

answering questions about operational details of the Armed Forces.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minority Leader.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, we have to appreciate the issues before us in proper perspective and the context that the Rules of this House allow. By the way, and for the avoidance of doubt, Order 85(1) provides, and I quote with the leave of the House, “The Speaker is solely responsible for the admissibility of a Question.”

Mr Speaker, the foundation upon which the supplementary question is being mounted has already been approved by the Speaker. This Question was admitted as an Urgent Question. The content of the Question and the content of the supplementary question are one and the same by way of import. The question provides,

“To ask the Minister for Defence what measures the Ministry is taking to ensure the territorial integrity, security of offices and citizens of Ghana in the midst of the recent political instability in Togo.”

Mr Speaker has admitted this Question. It has been advertised; communication has been transmitted to the Ministry, and the Minister is here to answer. So, it is too late in the day for any issue to be raised on admissibility, with the greatest respect.

The Minister, again, provides details in his Answer, and it is upon this that the respected Colleague from Bosome Freho is asking. So, for the Majority Leader to come in with a preliminary objection, Mr Speaker, in my view, is trying to displace you of your *bona fide*. It is not within his mandate because the Question has already been admitted.

If we come to Order 85(2), it says,

“When a Question is admitted by the Speaker, the Clerk shall immediately communicate the text to the Minister, Member or Head of the Independent Constitutional Body to whom the Question is addressed, and notify the Business Committee.”

The Speaker was notified, and the Minister was programmed to respond to the Question. The Member of Parliament is here discharging his duties. Now, the Majority Leader is raising security matters, invoking order 86(k), and saying that the Question itself is problematic, but he allowed it. It is not for the Majority Leader to allow or disallow, I beg to submit.

Order 86(k), which he interprets to mean that the Hon Member is discourteously referring to a foreign country. With respect to the Majority Leader, the Question was admitted by the Speaker. Mr Speaker, we need not belabour on this matter anymore.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I think I have heard a lot on this particular matter. It is not for any

reason that Members of our Security and Intelligence Committee had to take an oath in order to operate within the ambit of that Committee. The Question asked has been answered.

I am of the view that stretching it further into the detailed operational activities would have taken these security matters too far into the public domain. With all due respect, Hon Member, I will humbly overrule the Question. If you have another question, you may do so.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, as it pleases you, we will take note of the precedence. We thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you have the floor.

Yes, Majority Leader, the Member has not asked any questions.

Mr Ayariga: No, that is so. Just for the records of this House, we are all guided by our Rules, including the Speaker. The Rules say the Speaker should admit Questions, and the Rules state the conditions for the admissibility of Questions. Time and again in this House, Speakers have admitted Questions, but on the Floor, objections have been raised to those Questions and the Speakers' minds were drawn to certain considerations and based on those matters brought to the attention of the Speakers, they did not allow the Question to be answered.

So, one should not just say that because a Speaker has admitted a

Question, nobody can ever raise an objection to the Question being asked. Because Speakers are human, Judges are human, and that is why we have an opportunity to appeal cases up to the Supreme Court and even after they have ruled, to ask for a review because it is a human institution. We know that at any point, one can even raise questions of jurisdiction in litigation, even when the case has travelled far.

So the same way, a Speaker can admit a Question, but when his attention is drawn to certain issues, he may decide that the Question should not be asked. I do not want to make the world believe that once a Speaker has admitted a Question, no one in the Chamber can raise a question of the propriety or otherwise of the admissibility of that Question. If we say that if a Speaker has taken a decision, there is a procedure for challenging the decision of the Speaker, I agree. But I said that I saw it, flagged it, but did not object to the Question being asked. Even though I personally felt there was something wrong with that Question, I did not object to the Question being asked.

So I did not challenge the decision of the Speaker. I allowed the decision of the Speaker to prevail, but then it was the subsequent follow-up question that I was objecting to, which has been ruled on by the Speaker. I just want it for the purpose of the records.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Habib?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity.

The Majority Leader is abusing our Standing Orders and the proceedings of this House. Mr Speaker, with your permission, I will read Order 88(8), which says, "Where a Question has been asked and answered, no debate on it shall be permitted."

The Majority Leader is debating a Question that has been asked and answered. For that matter, whatever he is saying, he is debating the answer that was given. And our Rule says that where a question has been asked and answered, no debate on it shall be permitted.

So, Mr Speaker, rule the Majority Leader out, and let us continue. You have already directed that the question is overruled and that the Hon Member should ask another question. Whatever he is doing, he is now offending our orders. So let us make progress.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member.

3:16 p.m.

Mr Ayeh: Mr Speaker, the Minister gave some details. He talked about securing the Eastern frontiers and the Eastern Corridor. He mentioned the humanitarian logistics they are putting in place, the civil relations and cooperation; he mentioned how the Armed Forces are cooperating with the National Disaster Management Organisation (NADMO) to work on this; and he mentioned how the international agencies are even coming

in to help. Mr Speaker, that is why I typed my follow-ups. I am asking that has there been any deployment in the Eastern Corridor. Yes, or no? Not specifics.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, if our memories can serve us right, that was not the Question you asked. Your Question dealt with the detailed operational activities. —

Mr Ayeh: Mr Speaker, I read it out.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Do you have any further questions to ask?

Mr Ayeh: Yes, Mr Speaker, I have further questions to ask.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please ask the question.

Mr Ayeh: Mr Speaker, I want to ask the Minister whether Ghana submitted any redline declarations or contingency scenarios to the Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) or African Union (AU) in the event of total constitutional or any problem that happens around the Togo border and will Parliament be consulted should any decision of this nature be taken? Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, once again, this question is not really flowing from the Answer given by the Minister. If there has been communication to ECOWAS and all those other matters,

they do not flow from the Answer that the Minister has provided.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, be guided accordingly, and if that is your last question, then let us make progress.

Mr Ayeh: I want to ask if there has been some deployment in the Northern Region or the northern border of our country. I also want to ask, does the Ministry intend to sustain a military or financial capacity which will be extended to the border operation should the situation worsen?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, let us look at the questions you have asked.

“To ask the Minister for Defence what measures the Ministry is taking to ensure the territorial integrity, security of officers and citizens of Ghana in the midst of the recent political instability in Togo.”

Your Question is about measures taken, and the Minister has indicated the measures that have been taken. So if there is a supplementary question, it must not derogate from the main Question. That is what the Rule is telling us. Hon Members, this question is security in nature, so you may not get the answer that you want because of the environment that we find ourselves. International diplomacy will not allow certain things to be said on the Floor of the House.

Yes, Alhaji Habib?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I can understand the difficulty from the Majority Leader and the Majority Front Bench. However, if it is the case that the Questions have some security implications, the Minister should be guided and say so. But a question admitted, asked and then answered — if the Majority Leader keeps interfering in that, he should guide the Hon Minister as to what to say. But raising objection on the supplementary questions, Mr Speaker, you have that authority in overruling such supplementary questions. But the Majority Leader is just raising objections on that and we are not making progress. He has just asked and answered. He is entitled to supplementary questions and other Members too can ask if you permit.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I realised that you did the honourable thing of going to the Hon Member asking the Question. So, I would advise the Hon Member to take a cue so that we can make progress. You have done the honourable thing as a Whip. I saw everything, and I commend you highly for that.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not want to believe that the Hon Deputy Minister, Mr Ernest Brogya Genfi, my former Friend, is capable of answering. Unless you are suggesting that he cannot handle this Question. If it is the case that the Hon Deputy Minister does not have the capacity to respond to these questions, he should let us know. Because that is the indication he is giving us. But I know he can answer those questions, so give him the opportunity to

flow. Look at the way he is dressed. He has appeared in this Chamber today to respond to Questions. Look at him. But you are now stealing the day. Give him the opportunity to respond and if he is not capable of answering the question, let us know.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think that we should be careful how we treat matters in this Chamber. The First Deputy Minority Whip cannot be allowed to send the wrong and erroneous impression out that the Hon Minister cannot answer a Question. First and foremost, let us analyse his Question:

“To ask the Minister for Defence what measures the Ministry is taking to ensure the territorial integrity, security of officers and citizens of Ghana in the midst of the recent political instability in Togo.”

Security of officers in Togo at our embassy? Citizens of Ghana living in Togo? Are you getting the situation? Which officers? Living in Togo, or living in Ghana? What is the location of those officers? What is the location of those citizens? Is this a Question that a Minister for the Interior, Minister for Defence or Minister for Foreign Affairs should answer? We have allowed the Hon Member. As I looked at the Question, I saw the structural defects of that Question, but sometimes when relatively younger Members of the House are asking Questions, you allow them to ask the Question. But the follow-up question, I realised, was even getting

us into murkier areas. That is how come I tried to restrain him not because I wanted to stop him. This Question itself is problematic. Whose security; Ghanaians living in Ghana or in Togo? Soldiers located where, in Ghana or in Togo? Is it military officers or just personnel of Ghana Embassy in Togo? If that is the case, how is that the responsibility of the Minister for Defence? If we are talking about the security of Ghanaians in Togo because there is instability in Togo; how is the Hon Minister for Defence the person to answer Questions, if not the Minister for Foreign Affairs?

I indicated that he has concluded and branded Togo as a politically unstable country. I said that reference to Togo is not appropriate. We do not want to drag their matters into our national Parliament.

So, Mr Speaker, the Hon Member should not create the impression that the Minister cannot answer Questions. We have a responsibility to ensure that even those of us asking Questions act within the framework of our own rules. That is all I am trying to do. The Minister can answer the Question. He can get up and tell us that there are operational issues and therefore he cannot disclose operational issues. He has answered the Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Alhassan Tampuli Sulemana?

3.26 p.m.

Mr Alhassan Tampuli Sulemana: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I am a little concerned with the remarks that just

came from the Leader of the House. Under Order 85(1), and for the avoidance of doubt it reads: “The Speaker is responsible for the admissibility of a Question.”. Once the Speaker has admitted the Question, if a person raises matters such as ambiguity in the Question, then he is impugning the integrity of the Speaker. In this House, it is always said that “where you are in doubt, ask Bagbin”. Mr Speaker, I think that the Rt Hon Speaker did the right thing by admitting the Question.

Now, if the Hon Deputy Minister needs further clarification, it is up to him to raise it. It is not for the Leader of the House to raise impediments. As a matter of fact, I agree with what Hon Habib Iddrisu said that it appears that the Leader of the House is debating the Question. He should allow the questions to flow so that the Hon Deputy Minister—He asked permission for the Hon Deputy Minister to answer the Questions and I think he is capable enough to answer the Question. The Question has been admitted. If he needs clarification, he should say so.

Mr Speaker, this is just what I think. He is now abusing the Speaker, and that is not right. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon A.T. Sulemana, I take a great exception to the fact that I am being abused. I am not being abused. I think we are all getting something fundamentally wrong. The Question has been asked, and answer provided to the Question. We are now on supplementary questions. So, it is supplementary question that is under

reference. Hon Members, permit me to ask the Hon Member who asked the Question whether he has a supplementary question. If he does not have a supplementary question, we will be guided as to what to do. Hon Member, do you have a supplementary question?

Mr Ayeh: Yes, Mr Speaker. The Hon Deputy Minister made reference to communication and information operation as one of the measures that they are taking along the line. I want to ask, if we are we engaging the Cyber Security Authority (CSA), to give us some information on red lights, particularly when social media is involved? Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I would advise you to engage the Hon Deputy Minister, so that some information can be given to you. Yes, Hon Mahama?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Mr Speaker, I will need your direction on this matter. The Answer provided to the Urgent Question is not before Members for us to make contemporaneous determination as to whether the Questions we are asking are following directly — *[Interruption]*

Alhaji Suhuyini Sayibu Alhassan: It is an Urgent Question.

Dr Mahama: I am making a point. Can he be patient and listen to that? I know it is an Urgent Question. I have premised my question on the fact that it is an Urgent Question. I am asking for the direction of the Speaker whether or

not—Mr Speaker, I will need your guidance on this matter.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I am listening to you.

Dr Mahama: The Question was an Urgent Question and the Answer was provided. I have a supplementary question to ask, but I have the fear of having the statement that the question is not directly flowing from the Answer. Because I listened to the Answer. I have a different understanding of the Answer and some other person will have a different understanding of the Answer. That is what is causing this confusion, Mr Speaker. Can you properly allow the Hon Deputy Minister —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, we have taken one Answer. I do not think he has a different answer. By practise, because the Question asked is an Urgent Question, the Answer will not be published in the *Order Paper*. So, when Urgent Questions are asked, you all have to listen to the Answer as provided by the Hon Deputy Minister, and then you try to ask a question within the Answer. So, if you are not sure, having listened to the Hon Deputy Minister's Answer correctly, then it is better you remain seated and not make the attempt to ask a supplementary question.

Dr Mahama: All right, Mr Speaker, if you would indulge me, I will ask my supplementary question. Mr Speaker, I want to find out from the Hon Deputy Minister whether or not the Ministry has

received any credible report of any weapon trafficking.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Hon Member, before you land, file a fresh Question.

Yes, Hon Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I listened to the Hon Deputy Minister's responses which were largely comprehensive. However, I did not hear him state the measures that the Ministry has put in place to protect Ghanaian traders who ply their trade in the country, Togo. What has he done to protect them, ensuring their security and their safety? I did not hear that, so I would like him to —*[Interruption]* This is a harmless question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kingsley Nyarko, the question is not specifically demanding a specific category of people. It is asking of "measures taken to ensure territorial integrity, security of officers and citizens of Ghana in the midst of the recent political instability in Togo". There is no mention of traders for the Hon Deputy Minister's Answer to be specifically geared towards traders.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with all due respect, traders in Ghana are citizens of Ghana.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, the Answer provided covers citizens of Ghana, including traders.

Prof Nyarko: In the measures he outlined, I did not hear that and that is why I am asking that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, kindly resume your seat, since you agree that the traders are also citizens of Ghana. Yes, Hon Member for Manhyia South?

Mr Nana Agyei Baffour Awuah: Mr Speaker, respectfully, I would like to ask the Hon Deputy Minister whether there is a potential risk politically to Ghana in terms of the stability of our Government? We know that in certain instances where there is some degree of —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you have asked your question.

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, yes, there are not only political risks. If the situation in Togo escalates, there are economic risks involved and there are also social risks. For example, if there are inflows of refugees, the Republic of Ghana has to deal with it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Nitiwul. Hon Members, we have a lot of Questions today.

3:36 p.m.

Mr Dominic Bingab Aduna Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, I would want to crave your indulgence to let Parliament and the public know that this House has not tried to interfere in the internal affairs of Togo, neither has Ghana as a country tried, by this Question, to interfere in the

internal affairs of Togo. It will help us a lot if we cleared that doubt, Mr Speaker, and you are the only one who can do it. It is important for us.

But for the supplementary question, I want to find out from the Hon Deputy Minister for Defence whether he is confirming to us that indeed soldiers have been deployed to the border instead of men of the Ministry of the Interior. Because we know that the Ministry of the Interior is the first port of call when it comes to issues of internal security. Is the Deputy Minister confirming to us by his answer that indeed, for this particular issue that is happening in Togo, he has deployed soldiers to the border?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, we have all listened to the Deputy Minister very loud and clear. There is no need confirming anything that he said because the Deputy Minister did not disagree with anything.

Yes, Mr Dafeamekpor?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I was going to react within the terms of Order 88(7) that: “A Member, in asking the Question, shall not (a) address the House...” He stood up and decided to address the House; the rule does not permit that. He also decided to be argumentative; the rule forbids that. He does not have the opportunity to address this House. He has decided to address the House, and I am saying that the rule forbids that. So, I urge Mr Speaker to rule him out.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I allowed that because what he said is very important so that we do not leave here creating erroneous impression in the minds of the people. That was the basis for allowing him to make that particular statement.

Hon Members, we have about 13 other Questions so I think for the Urgent Questions, we have taken enough supplementary. I would then give the floor to the Minority Leader.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, I recognise the Minister for Roads and Highways.

Mr Governs Kwame Agbodza: Mr Speaker, Colleagues have every right to ask Ministers to respond to issues as they please. But Standing Order 77(2) also says:

(2) Question time shall ordinarily not exceed one hour except that the Speaker may permit a Question after the expiration of the time stated.”

Mr Speaker, I am asked an average of 10 Questions in a week. We come and sit here, and we have done about one hour on one Question, debating whether it was necessary or not. Is it the case that when we bring Ministers here — Colleagues, not too long ago the same argument was made. Is it the case that once we drag Ministers here, we can let them spend the entire day here because this is Parliament? Or Parliament itself also

needs to work within the rules we set for ourselves? Maybe, Mr Speaker, you need to — I remember the Majority Leader tried to draw the attention of the Chair to this issue some time ago. Either we stick strictly to the one-hour rule that when it is time for Questions, we do that within one hour. When the one hour is done, if it is not a substantive question, we allow the Ministers to go back to the Ministry and do some work.

Because if I spend the entire day here only listening to other things other than Questions put to Ministers, I do not think we are serving the people better. So, we are just drawing your attention to the fact that Question time cannot become an open-ended debate in the House or debating the provisions in the Standing Order.

Mr Speaker, my humble appeal.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Your concern is well noted.

Hon Member, Question time is generally one hour. However, the person presiding may extend the period beyond one hour depending on the circumstances. But generally, Question time is supposed to be one hour.

Yes, Minority Leader?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, the Deputy Minister, in his Answer, indicated that the Government has deployed some soldiers as part of protecting the territorial

integrity of our country. May I know from him whether sufficient operational deployment has been put in place to deal with any escalation that may occur?

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, the operation along the border is a joint operation of the Ghana Armed Forces and other security agencies. So, adequate deployment measures have been taken in order to ensure that when the situation escalates, we would be able to deal with it.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, on the issue of safety of our soldiers that have deployed, can the Deputy Minister tell the House whether sufficient logistics have been deployed to ensure their safety? You and I know that when we send men and women to such operations —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, I think your Question is clear so let the Question remain fresh in the mind of the Minister—

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, as it pleases you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Deputy Minister?

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, the safety of our men is always considered when we do deployment. So, in this particular case, every safety measure, logistically and other means, has been taken to ensure that our men are safe while they undertake their duties along the border.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, finally, I would like to know from the Hon Deputy Minister the steps

that the Government has taken so far, as part of the deployment to ensure the protection of citizens of Ghana who may be caught in this tension along the borders.

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, without going into details about the operational activities, I answered that the operational activities have taken into consideration how to protect our citizens who trade along the borders.

3:46 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, that brings us to the end of Urgent Questions.

We would move to the Oral Answers to Questions. But before we move to that, permit me to introduce some important guests in our midst.

Hon Members, the African Parliamentarians' Network Against Corruption (APNAC), would in collaboration with the Parliament of Ghana hold its Biennial General Meeting in Accra from Friday, 7th November to Sunday 9th November, 2025.

The three-day event which brings together Members of the Parliaments of Member States of APNAC and invited guests will provide among others a platform for open dialogue, on the future of APNAC, the persistent and multifaceted challenges of corruption and its impacts on governance and development.

Hon Members, I have the pleasure to introduce to you the APNAC African Board Members. First on my list is the Speaker of Parliament of Benin and President of APNAC, in the person of Rt Hon Louis Gbehounou Vlavonou, Vice President, Hon Peter Temba Mliswa, Senator Dr Pierre Flambeau Ngayap, a Member from Cameroon, Hon Dr Jean-Pierre Pasi Zapamba Buka, a Member from D.R.Congo, Hon Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah, a Member from Ghana's Parliament—*[Hear1 Hear!]*

Hon Members, other APNAC Members are Hon Behanzi Edouard, Benin, Hon Ajai Titilayo, Benin and Hon Shakeel Shabir from Kenya. They are here with their Secretary, Mr Fabrice Fifonsi, Executive Director— *[Hear1 Hear!]*

Hon Members, on behalf of the House, I welcome the delegation to Parliament and I wish them fruitful deliberations in their APNAC meetings.

[APNAC Africa Board Members were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we also have students and other visitors with us. We have Lashibi Community School led by Adzakli M. Augusts, a teacher. They are from Tema West and are 72 in number.

[Pupils of Lashibi Community School were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We have Ghana National Association of Teachers (GNAT) led by Fidlis Kwasi Damba, a teacher; they are from Nkwanta and 12 in number.

[Members of the Ghana National Association of Teachers (GNAT) were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We have Omart Royal School led by Tseh Kwame Mawuli, the headteacher. They are from Kpone Katamanso and are 100 number.

[Pupils of Omart Royal School were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We have Education for Change led by Abubakari Ahmed, Executive Director. They are from the Tolon Constituency and they number 41.

[Members of Education for Change were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Then, we have Kwame Adom Complex led by Isaac Adum, manager. They are from Asante Akyem South; they numbered 70.

[Pupils from Kwame Adom Educational Complex were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, on your behalf, I welcome all of them to the Parliament of Ghana and I wish them a fruitful visit.

Hon Members, we then proceed to the Oral Questions, for the Minister for Defence. With the same permission that the Deputy Minister should answer the Question, I proceed to call on Professor Kingsley Nyarko, Member of Parliament for Kwadaso, to ask his Question.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF DEFENCE

Plans to Maintain Professionalism in the Ghana Armed Forces

Prof Kingsley Nyarko (NPP — Kwadaso): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Defence, how the Ministry plans to maintain professionalism in the Armed Forces of Ghana and enhance its capacity in protecting our territorial integrity and sustaining our democracy.

Deputy Minister for Defence (Mr Ernest Brogya Genfi) on behalf of Ag. Minister for Defence: The Ministry of Defence (MoD) is committed to maintaining the highest standards of professionalism within the Ghana Armed Forces (GAF), enhancing the capacity to protect the nation's territorial integrity, and supporting sustainable democratic governance.

In maintaining professionalism and enhancing capacity, the Ministry continuously undertakes the following key strategic activities:

Professional Development and Training

Training policies and procedures are under constant review for optimal results. The Department of Training coordinates tactical, operational, trade, specialized, and physical training to enhance effectiveness and capacity across all GAF commands:

The training involves local training, higher educational initiative and overseas training. Training emphasises military ethics, discipline, human rights and civil-military relations to equip personnel for effective socio-economic contribution and national defence.

Recruitment and Retention Reforms

The Ministry ensures a transparent, merit-based recruitment process to attract the best candidates nationwide.

Retention strategies focus on improved welfare, housing, healthcare and career progression to maintain a capable force.

Capacity Building and Modernisation

Investments in advanced surveillance systems, maritime security assets, air assets, patrol technologies, and infrastructure improvements (including forward operating bases and logistics systems) are being pursued to add value to personnel.

3:56 p.m.

Efforts in Sustaining Democracy

GAF supports democratic institutions as mandated by the Constitution (Article 210), respecting civilian authority and constitutional governance.

Mr Speaker, where there are any reported unauthorised operation or indiscipline on the part of personnel, the GAF ensures disciplinary systems are enforced timeously in accordance with

law to maintain discipline and professionalism in the Service.

The training architecture of the Ghana Armed Forces is aimed at deterring terrorism and violent extremism thereby maintaining the stability necessary for democratic governance.

Mr Speaker, it is worthy of mention that the participation of Ghana Armed Forces in UN mission has bolstered GAF image in terms of professionalism, best practices and respect for human rights. This has reinforced democratic principles within the rank and file of the personnel of the Ghana Armed Forces.

The Ministry of Defence prioritises professionalism, continuous training, modernisation, inter-agency collaboration, and strict adherence to constitutional and ethical standards in managing the Ghana Armed Forces. These measures ensure a disciplined, capable force committed to Ghana's sovereignty, democratic stability, and socio-economic advancement.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Minister.

Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko, any supplementary question?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I thank the Hon Minister for the answers provided. Under the item numbered 3(a), the Minister talked about transparency and merit-based recruitment process. I

would like to find out from him how transparent and meritorious the recruitment process is and also regarding career progression in terms of promotion.

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, the Ghana Armed Forces published the qualifications and criteria for recruitment and that is done through national communication platforms and this is open and transparent enough for anybody that wants to join the Ghana Armed Forces. In terms of promotions, there are laid down procedures which are in accordance with the Ghana Armed Forces' Regulations and the Ministry ensures that these Regulations are strictly adhered to.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any further supplementary questions?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, my understanding of merit-based promotion or intervention is merit-based promotion or intervention. It means that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you know the rules: when you are to ask a supplementary question, you do not argue.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, so is the Hon Minister telling the House that the promotion or the recruitment is solely merit-based and none else?

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, the promotions are guided by the Ghana

Armed Forces' Regulations and these Regulations detail all the things that have to be considered and I can assure the Hon Member that it is merit-based.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, the focus of the question was on professionalism in the Ghana Armed Forces. I would like to find out from the Minister if in his candid view and opinion, whether the sacking the top brass of the military recently compromises or undermines the professionalism—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What is your supplementary question?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, it seems you were not listening to me. My question is that does the recent sacking of the top brass of the military compromise professionalism in the Ghana Armed Forces of Ghana, in the Minister's opinion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, this cannot be a supplementary question. The question is overruled. Ask another question?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, he is talking about professionalism and I am asking that does that act, in his opinion, undermine that process?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you cannot argue with me. The question is overruled. Do you have another question to ask?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect, you are not being fair to me. This is a harmless question and I know my very good friend is capable of answering this question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, if you want to file a Question on the dismissal of any perceived person in the military, do so, but that cannot be by way of a supplementary question.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, my last question is that how does the Minister assure us that the democratic gains that we have achieved so far will still be with us and nothing will undermine it?

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the question is, how can the Minister assure us that the democratic gains that we have achieved will still be with us and will not be undermined? The Hon Member should listen to the question himself. How does this flow from the Question about professionalism among others of the military? Clearly, it does not flow from the substantive Question, which is what a follow-up question should be.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with all due respect to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, before you come in, let me place on record that it is not compulsory that you ask, by necessity, a supplementary question and up to three

supplementary questions. So, if you have one or two supplementary questions, you are alright. But the rule says you have up to three supplementary questions. So, if you do not have three supplementary questions, it is not mandatory that your supplementary questions must, as a matter of course, be three. Well, you have the floor.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with all due respect, your assumption is wrong. You cannot know whether I have one, two or three. It does not lie—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, I am just admonishing the whole House, not specifically to you.

Prof Nyarko: But the Question was on two legs. An aspect was about democracy, so I asked a question on the professionalism in terms of protecting our territorial integrity and the second one was on democratic gains. The Leader of the House was not listening. The Leader of the House probably did not even see that aspect of the question. Because if the military does not abide by the tenets of professionalism, it can undermine our democratic gains. So, what is wrong with this question?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, I realised that you are mindful of providing an answer to the question, so you have the floor.

4:06 p.m.

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, the Ghana Armed Forces is a creation of the Constitution and as I provided in my Answer,

The Ghana Armed Forces respects the constitutional democracy that we have, and they have committed to it and so I would want to assure the Hon Member that the Ghana Armed Forces will remain professional and protect our constitutional democracy.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Dr Kabiru Tiah Mahama?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Despite their commitment and fidelity to professionalism, there are still reports of army officers brutalising citizens, be it in Walewale, Binduri, or Garu, there is still that problem of military officers brutalising the citizens. I would want to ask the Hon Minister what is going wrong and how are they going to address it.

Mr Dafeamekpor — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Dafeamekpor?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the supplementary question from Dr Tiah Mahama clearly offends Order 89(1). For the sake of record, let me read what Order 89 (1) says. I read:

“As soon as a Question is answered, any Member beginning with the Member who asked the Question may, without notice, ask a Supplementary Question for further

clarification of any matter of fact on the answer but a Supplementary Question shall not introduce a matter not included in the original question”.

So, Mr Speaker, his present question clearly introduces a new matter, not contained in the original Question. If he is minded, he should ask his own question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, what is the new matter?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that “the people in Walewale are being brutalised”, and that what is happening?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Question is on maintaining professionalism in the Armed Forces, and the Hon Member agreed with the steps being taken by the Ministry to ensure professionalism in the Armed Forces. He is asking that although all those steps have been taken to ensure professionalism in the Armed Forces, there is still the case of some sort of brutality on the part of the military, so what does the Hon Deputy Minister say to that?

Hon Deputy Minister, what is your response?

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, where there are any reported unauthorised operations or indiscipline on the part of any personnel, the Ghana Armed Forces ensures that internal disciplinary measures are undertaken to serve as deterrence for any other personnel who

may go out of his way to engage in any such act.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we will now move to the Question numbered 490 which is in the name of Hon Member of Parliament for Hohoe, Mr Thomas Worlanyo Tsekpo. This also to the Minister responsible for Defence.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

Peace and Security Plans for Alavanyo-Nkonya Corridor

Mr Thomas Worlanyo Tsekpo (NDC — Hohoe): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Defence whether the Ministry has plans to establish a terrorism training centre and Forward Operating Base between Alavanyo and Nkonya as part of efforts to consolidate the lasting peace in the area and ensure security, development and productive use of the disputed land.

Alhaji Iddrisu Habib — rose —

Mr Genfi: The Alavanyo-Nkonya conflict, rooted in a protracted land boundary dispute dating back to 1923, has led to decades of violence, killings, and reprisals between the two communities. The contested land, a plateau between Nkonya and Alavanyo Kpeme, remains unresolved, with both sides maintaining interest.

The conflict has deeply impacted both communities, damaging

infrastructure, disrupting transport and education, stifling economic and social life through curfews and altering travel routes due to ongoing insecurity.

However, I am glad to report that presently, both sides have committed to cede the contested land to the Ghana Armed Forces (GAF) for military training purposes. The location of the land aligns with GAF's ongoing national expansion and reorganisation programme aimed at strengthening internal security and addressing threats such as terrorism and other cross-border crimes.

To further exert dominance in the area and put the disrupted land into productive use, the GAF has proposed the establishment of a Special Forces/Jungle Training School and Forward Operating Base (FOB). The training school will therefore be established as part of the Medium-Term Plan of the Ministry.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Alhaji Habib Iddrisu?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I was trying to catch your eye when the Hon Deputy Minister was answering the Question. Mr Speaker, I do not know if I am wrong or the Question is not properly put. It says:

“To ask the Minister for Defence whether the Ministry has plans to establish a terrorism training centre”.

Is it “anti-terrorism training centre or a terrorism training centre”?

Mr Speaker, I do not know whether in Ghana we want to train terrorists. So, that is why I wanted to draw your attention to whether it is “anti-terrorism training centre or terrorism training centre”.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, this afternoon, the Minority Side spent several minutes arguing that once the Rt Hon Speaker has admitted a Question, nobody can challenge. So, whatever the wording of the Question is, the Minister is answering the Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, do you have a supplementary question?

Mr Tsekpo: No, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Alhaji Habib Iddrisu, do you have a supplementary question?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Yes, Mr Speaker, I have a supplementary question.

Mr Speaker, does the Hon Deputy Minister have data of terrorists in Ghana to open a training centre for them?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, with all due respect, your question is disallowed.

In the absence of any further supplementary questions, may we move to the Question numbered 578 in the name of Hon Member for Jaman South,

Mr Kwadwo Damoah. This is also to the Minister for Defence.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

Steps to Repair Presidential Jet

Col Rtd Kwadwo Damoah (NDC — Jaman South): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Defence what specific steps the Ministry is taking to repair the presidential jet (Dassault Falcon 900EX EASY) which has been grounded in France since 11th March, 2025 due to serious corrosion problems.

4:16 p.m.

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, the Falcon 900Ex EASY aircraft was ferried to Dassault Falcon Service (DFS) in Le Bourget, France, on Tuesday, 11 Mar 25, for the 24-monthly/1600FH periodic inspection. This inspection is a mandatory airworthiness requirement that ensures that the main maintenance tasks and the due list tasks compiled for the 24-monthly inspections have been completed and functional checks successfully carried out. Also, the reported corrosion spots detected within the aircraft’s fuel tanks, which affected the aircraft’s delivery date, have undergone extensive repairs. These corrosion issues in the fuel tanks have since been resolved.

However, in the course of the inspection, fuel leakages were observed from the Right-hand (RH) wing tank. Unfortunately, after successfully repairing the section of the wing that experienced the leakages, another

challenge was encountered while reinstalling the lower panel beneath the wing. This occurrence has resulted in further delay in the completion of the inspection.

Following the difficulties encountered, Dassault Aviation invited the Falcon Wing Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) to the DFS hangars to enable the OEM to conduct an on-site assessment of the RH wing lower panel and provide independent technical recommendations aimed at expediting the repair and reinstallation process. The repair from the OEM has been successfully carried out, and the RH wing repair has also been completed.

Mr Speaker, upon the completion of this rectification, the aircraft has to undergo a leak test of the fuel tanks, a third engine ground run, painting of the wing lower panel and finally an acceptance flight will be performed. The Falcon 900EX aircraft will return to Ghana after all the necessary tests.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, do you have a supplementary question?

Col Damoah: Mr Speaker, yes, I have some follow-up questions.

Mr Speaker, I want to thank the Minister for the initial response, but I want to find out when exactly the original equipment manufacturer repair was completed; the date and day.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, if you are looking at the specific date at which an act is performed, you should have directed your Question as such, so that the Minister, in coming to answer, will provide you with a specific date. A supplementary question is not supposed to spring a surprise.

You asked the Minister the steps that have been taken to ensure that the equipment is repaired. Now your supplementary question is on a specific date on which an act was performed. Hon Member, we need to be fair and operate within the rules. So ask another question.

Col Damoah: Mr Speaker, I am still referring to his Answer. He says the repair from the original equipment manufacturer has been successfully carried out. So, certainly it was done at a specific time—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, you are asking for a specific date on which it was carried out. And I am saying that if that is your question, it should be a specific Question where a Minister will refer to the record and tell you the specific date. We are all human beings. Please ask another question.

Col Damoah: My other question would have followed from the answer he would give for this because he says the aircraft is going to return to Ghana. And I am going to ask—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, if you do not have another question, you can resume your seat.

Col Damoah: I do have.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please ask.

Col Damoah: I will ask, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I want to find out from the Hon Minister when the remaining tests are going to be conducted so that we have insights on when we should expect the aircraft in Ghana.

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, the aircraft is currently undergoing all the necessary tests, and once the test is completed, the aircraft will return to Ghana. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any other questions? Hon Member, if you do not have any supplementary, indicate.

Col Damoah: Mr Speaker, I am all right.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Dr Kabiru?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Mr Speaker, the Answer provided by the Minister on page 15, the second paragraph states, and I quote,

“Unfortunately, after successfully repairing the section of the wing that experienced the leakage, another challenge was encountered while reinstalling the lower panel beneath the wing.”

Mr Speaker, the Minister’s Answer falls short of telling the other challenge that came up. What is the other challenge

that was encountered? I could not decipher that. Can the Minister provide clarity on that? Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, the challenge has to do with the wing of the aircraft, and that is why they had to engage the original equipment manufacturer in order to resolve it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Dr Kabiru, you know there cannot be a follow-up question on a follow-up. Yes?

Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni: Mr Speaker, I want to find out from the Deputy Minister when the people of Ghana should expect our presidential jet to be back in Ghana.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Question asked and answered. Yes, Hon Member?

Nana Agyei Baffour Awuah: Mr Speaker, I want to find out from the Minister, in respect of the third paragraph of his Answer, that upon the completion of this rectification, the aircraft has to undergo a leak test of the fuel tanks and so on. Is it not the case that upon repair works, they have to satisfy themselves that everything has been fixed, or is it a separate check that is going to be done? Because it comes across as a separate work which is going to be done.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, do not violate our rules.

Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, the current issue that was dealt with had to do with the leak of the fuel tanks. So once they are done, the specific test that will be run includes the fuel tanks and a ground engine run. And where they have to fix the wing has to be painted.

4:26 p.m.

All of these have to be completed before the aircraft will return to Ghana. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, I think you are looking at your back. If I give you the floor, I will not go back. Yes?

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko (NPP — Effia): Mr Speaker, from the Minister's response, it is clear that the aircraft had gone on a regular maintenance. From the fallout from the maintenance, several other challenges came up. The subsequent challenges that were identified, did the service company get the concurrence of Government of Ghana before continuing with the extra repairs? This is because it will be coming at an additional cost to the State. I want to know whether all these extra problems that have come as a result of—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, do they have the concurrence to continue the other jobs?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: We can have two more.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I indicated that we have about 13 Questions. If you are given the opportunity to ask a supplementary question, it is not a period for you to tell a story.

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, the aircraft was sent for servicing by the Ministry. So, once anything is detected, the Ministry is notified. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: In view of the number of Questions that we have, I will take two more, including the Leadership. Yes, Mr Matthew Nyindam?

Mr Matthew Nyindam (NPP — Kpandai): Mr Speaker, I am happy that as a nation, we have all agreed now that our presidential jet has a problem, and we are working on it, duly acknowledged by the Deputy Minister for Defence. I want to find out from the Deputy Minister, looking at all the steps and the subsequent servicing that he is talking about, can he assure Ghanaians and all of us that if this presidential jet comes back, that will be the presidential jet that the President will be using? Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, file a fresh Question. This Question has to do with steps being taken to ensure the maintenance, please.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu, you have the floor.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, considering the answers the Hon Deputy Minister for Defence provided

concerning the current status of the aircraft, does the Ministry have any plan to buy any aircraft?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Leader, you may file a fresh Question. This Question has nothing to do with the purchase of an aircraft.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, if you read the Question very well, it is talking about the specific steps the Ministry is taking to repair the presidential jets. The Deputy Minister in his answer stated that the very Answer that was provided to this House, by the former Minister for Defence, may his soul rest in peace, was—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, the answer is published. Show me in the Minister's answer where he referred to a purchase of an aircraft. If not, kindly resume your seat.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, my question is that the Hon Minister said the reason the aircraft was taken for repairs were addressed, and then upon that a new development occurred, based on his answer. I am asking the Hon Minister, based on the fact that you went for a problem that was in the tank, now a new problem has come on the wing, do you have any plan of buying any aircraft?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, file a new Question.

Yes, Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib?

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, may I find out from the Hon

Deputy Minister, can you assure this House that after all the servicing, this will be an aircraft that we can still rely on and fly in comfort?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Genfi: Mr Speaker, the reason for the maintenance and all the problems identified is for the aircraft to be airworthy. So, once the manufacturer certifies that the aircraft is airworthy, then the aircraft can fly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

Hon Members, we have come to the end of Question numbered 578. We move to Question numbered 200, standing in the name of Dr Ebenezer Prince Arhin.

Hon Deputy Minister for Defence, on behalf of the House, we thank you very much for attending upon the House and providing answers to all these Questions scheduled for you. Thank you very much.

Hon Members, the next Question in line is scheduled for the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources, who is comfortably in our midst to provide answers to those Questions. So, I will urge upon the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources to take his designated seats. Now the first question for him is Question number 200, standing in the name of Dr Ebenezer Prince Arhin, Member of Parliament for Mfantseman. Hon Member, you have the floor.

MINISTRY OF WORKS, HOUSING AND WATER RESOURCES

Water Supply Crisis in Mfantseman Constituency

Dr Ebenezer Prince Arhin (NDC — Mfantseman): Mr Chairman, I beg to ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources when the water crisis in the Mfantseman Constituency will be resolved?

Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources (Mr Kenneth Gilbert Adjei): Thank you, Mr Speaker. The Baifikrom Water Treatment Plant supplies water to Ghana Water Limited customers in the Mfantseman Constituency. The plant was built in 1965, rehabilitated and expanded in 2008 by Spaans Bangkok. The current plant production capacity is 12,244 cubic meters per day (2.7 Million Gallons per Day). Raw water from the Irrigation Development Authority (IDA) dam flows by gravity to the plant for treatment. Raw Water Abstraction point has also been built on the River Ochi-Amissah close to the Dam to pump raw water from River Ochi-Amissah to augment the IDA dam level. The plant serves three (3) political districts, namely Ekumfi, Ajumako-Enyan-Essiam and Mfantseman.

Mr Speaker, extreme dry weather condition experienced in the country in the last quarter of 2024 coupled with erratic rainfall pattern this year resulted in the reduction of raw water availability for abstraction from the IDA dam

reservoir for production. The water abstraction dwindled from an average of 7,500 cubic meters per day (1.7 Million Gallons per Day) in December 2024 to 4,400 cubic meters per day (0.98 Million Gallons per Day) in March 2025. The situation further deteriorated during April and May 2025, leading to frequent instances of raw water being unavailable for treatment throughout the majority of days in these months.

Communities such as Mankessim, Saltpond, Anomabo, Enyan Apaa, Gyedu Baifikrom within the Mfantseman Constituency and its environs were badly hit and affected by the drying up of the IDA dam reservoir.

4:36 p.m.

Mr Speaker, Ghana Water Limited has used its Internally Generated Funds (IGF) to procure and install two (2) new horizontal pumps downstream of the Weir Intake on river Ochi Amissah to pump 200 cubic meter per hour of water directly to the Water Treatment Plant for production every day. The makeshift water abstraction arrangement strategically controls the withdrawal of water from the IDA multi-purpose dam reservoir in the wet or rainy season to ensure that water levels in the dam increases to support adequate abstraction during the dry season. Ghana Water Limited has also redefined the Essakyir water supply area to include areas, which hitherto were supplied by the Baifikrom water supply system. The intervention is intended to ensure that the present water production shortfall from the Baifikrom water headworks does not affect water supply in the Mfantseman Constituency.

Mr Speaker, within the medium term, Ghana Water Limited has carried out a comprehensive desilting of the Ochi-Amissah River channel to enable sufficient water to be pumped into the IDA Dam reservoir to guarantee adequate volumes for abstraction and production during the dry season.

For the long term, Ghana Water Limited has commenced procurement processes to supply and install a new 1200 cubic meters per day (0.26 Million Gallons per Day) pump set in the Ochi-Amissah River to pump adequate volume of water to the IDA dam reservoir for purposes of achieving all year-round abstraction and production. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Arhin: I have no supplementary question except to appreciate the Minister's effort in helping Mfantseman resolve its water crisis.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this is a constituency-specific Question.

We then move to the Question numbered 270, standing in the name of Hon Bismark Tetteh Nyarko, Member of Parliament for Upper Manya Krobo. Hon Member, you have the floor.

Completion of Bukunor Water Expansion Project

Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko (NDC — Upper Manya Krobo): Thank you,

Mr Speaker. Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources the plans of the Ministry to complete the abandoned Bukunor Water Expansion Project which when completed will supply potable water for Bukunor Water Treatment facilities to Asesewa and other communities in the district.

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, the Bukunor Water Expansion Project was undertaken as part of a broader programme by the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources to improve access to potable water in the Eastern Region, particularly, Koforidua township and adjoining communities. The project, which was funded by the Government of Belgium, was completed in 2009. The project undertook the construction of a 19,400m³ per day (4.3 Million Gallons of Water per Day) Water Treatment Plant at Bukunor. The raw water source for the Water Treatment Plant is a tributary of the Volta River at Kasakope. The treated water from the Bukunor Plant is transmitted to Koforidua township and adjoining communities through a 35km transmission pipeline.

Mr Speaker, communities in Upper Manya Krobo, including Asesewa and its surroundings, is supplied with potable water from a small-town pipe water system which is managed by the Community Water and Sanitation Agency. As a result, the supply of water from the Bukunor Water Treatment Plant to Asesewa and its surroundings was not undertaken during the implementation of the project.

Mr Speaker, the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources is committed to the sustainable delivery of potable water to all, regardless of a person's geographical location or status. In line with this, I have directed the Ghana Water Limited and the Community Water and Sanitation Agency to collaborate in assessing the feasibility of implementing a long-term solution to the water supply challenges in the Upper Manya Krobo area.

Mr Nyarko: I must thank the Hon Minister for being sincere with his Answer. Mr Speaker, Asesewa is currently the district capital for Upper Manya Krobo, and it appears to have expanded beyond the production capacity—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are violating our Rules. If you do not have a supplementary question—

Mr Nyarko: I want to thank the Hon Minister for directing for that collaboration. We will collaborate with him to ensure that the water problems are solved.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Question numbered 317, standing in the name of Mr Thomas Winsum Anabah, Member of Parliament for Garu.

Provision of Garu Town with a Water System

Mr Thomas Winsum Anabah (NDC — Garu): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I beg to ask the Minister for

Works, Housing and Water Resources the measures the Ministry is taking to provide the fast-developing Garu town with a town water system.

Mr Adjei: Mr Speaker, the Garu Water Supply System which is being managed by the Garu community is based on abstraction of groundwater from four mechanised boreholes, which is pumped into a 200 m³ High Level Tank (HLT) and distributed by gravity to the Garu community through a network of pipelines. Currently, only two out of the four boreholes are functional.

Mr Speaker, it must be noted that a lot of community piped water systems are under the direct management of various communities with oversight responsibility by the respective Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies. Most of these systems have been bedevilled with a lot of issue such as continuous breakdown of water systems, with around 40 per cent non-functional at any point, deteriorating water quality, high non-revenue water, huge unpaid electricity bills, poor accountability for revenue and high levels of customer indebtedness.

Mr Speaker, to address these issues and ensure the sustainability of water supply services for rural areas and small towns, the Community Water and Sanitation Agency (CWSA), as part of its reform agenda, engaged with the Garu Community to facilitate CWSA's assumption of management responsibilities for the Garu Water System. However, this proposal was initially declined by the community.

Mr Speaker, the CWSA is currently re-engaging the community, seeking approval to assume control of the water system so that comprehensive plans can be developed for its rehabilitation and expansion. The Ministry will work with CWSA and the Garu District to determine the scope and cost of the proposed expansion. Once these have been established, they will be incorporated into the Ministry's medium-term plan for potential funding and implementation. Thank you.

Mr Anabah: In his response, the Hon Minister told us that most of the systems in the communities have been bedevilled with a lot of issues such as continuous breakdown, among others. These continuous breakdowns, we have observed, are associated with poor electricity supply and current surges. —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I think you are completely out of order.

Mr Anabah: Is the Hon Minister considering using alternative power sources, like solar systems or others, for these water supply systems that do not depend solely on the Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG)? That is my question.

Mr Adjei: Currently, the Ministry is actually using solar-powered pumps for small-town water supply systems.

4:46 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further supplementary? Hon Members,

in the absence of any further supplementary question, that brings us to the last Question slated for the Hon Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources.

I want to thank the Hon Minister very much for attending upon the House to respond to the Questions slated for him. Hon Minister, you are hereby discharged. We then move to the Question numbered 299.

Mr Ricketts- Hagan: Mr Speaker, I was going to indulge you to alter the order of Business so that the Minister for Education can present two Papers which is slated, before we come back to the Minister for Roads and Highways to answer his Questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, at the pre-Sitting meeting, there was an indication that copies of those Bills need to be given the Leadership. Thereafter, Leadership would look at it and get it laid.

Mr Ricketts- Hagan: Mr Speaker, I hear they are here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, call for copies of those Bills.

Hon Members, the Minister for Roads and Highways is seated to respond to his Questions —

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I have a copy of the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology Bill, 2025

and I also have a letter from the Office of the President communicating to me that Cabinet has granted approval for the passage of the Bill. So, I think that —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I would plead with you to get more copies available and probably tomorrow we would look at it at the pre-Sitting and same can be taken.

May I ask the Minister for Roads and Highways to take the designated seat. The first Question slated for him is the Question numbered 299 standing in the name of Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko, Member of Parliament for Upper Manya Krobo. You have the floor.

MINISTRY OF ROADS AND HIGHWAYS

Status of the Asesewa-Abuorso Road

Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko (NDC—Upper Manya Krobo): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the status of the Asesewa-Abuorso Road.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

Background

The Asesewa - Abuorso (IR3) Road forms part of the Koforidua - Asesewa - Abuorso Road Project (km 0.0 - 65.20). It links New Juabeng South Municipality, Yilo Krobo Municipality and Fanteakwa North District.

Current Programme

The project was awarded under the Contract titled “Reconstruction of Koforidua – Asesewa – Abourso Road (km 0.0 - 65.2)”. The works commenced on 3rd January, 2021 for completion by 4th January, 2025. The progress of work is estimated at 67 per cent physical completion. The contractor is at site and works are ongoing.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr B. T. Nyarko: Mr Speaker, the people of Asesewa thank the Minister for Roads and Highways for bringing the contractor back to site.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Hon Members, this is a constituency specific Question. We move to the Question numbered 356, standing in the name of Maxwell Kwame Lukutor, Member of Parliament for South Tongu.

Resumption of Construction Works on the Lolito–Hawui/Adidokpo Road

Ing Surv Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (NDC—South Tongu): I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the Government would continue works on the Lolito-Hawui/Adidokpo Road after construction of culverts since 2008.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I thought my Colleague would have acknowledged the fact that we have started a number of

projects as well already before asking me when we are going to start new ones. So, Mr Speaker, on record, we have started a number of new projects, including an emergency one that he called for, which has been carried out as well. But that is not part of the Question so this is the response to the Question he asked.

Background

The Lolito – Hawui/Adidokpo Road is a section of a road captured in the Department of Feeder Roads (DFR) database as Lotito - Amedormekope Jnc -Gamenu Feeder Road 37.8km long. The road is located in the South Tongu Municipality of the Volta Region. The first 15km is an engineered gravel road in poor surface condition whilst the remaining length is unengineered in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering studies and cost estimates will be carried out on the road for consideration under the 2026 Budget upon the availability of funds.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Ing Surv Lukutor: Yes, Mr Speaker. I would want to commend the Minister highly for the good job he is doing in the road sector. During the time for the supplementary question, I want to commend him and His Excellency John

Dramani Mahama for the good job they are doing —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you do not have a supplementary question. Kindly resume your seat.

We then move to the Question numbered 373, standing in the name of Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe, Member of Parliament for Suhum.

Completion of Road Projects in Ntunkum, Adarkwa, Otwebediadua, and Gariba Zongo Communities

Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (NPP — Suhum): Mr Speaker I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the roads in the following communities would be completed:(i) Ntunkum (ii) Adarkwa (iii) Otwebediadua (iv) Gariba Zongo.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

Background

The Ntunkum, Adarkwa, Otwebediadua and Gariba Zongo are communities along the Suhum-Nankese Feeder Road which is located in the Suhum Municipality of the Eastern Region. It is an engineered bituminous surface dressing road in poor condition.

Current Programme

The Suhum-Nankese feeder road was awarded under the contract titled “Bitumen Surfacing of Suhum- Nankese Feeder Road - PH I (10km)”.

The contract was awarded on 30th September, 2020 for completion by 29th November, 2022. The overall progress of works is estimated at 72 per cent physical completion. The contractor is currently not on site and works have stalled due to delay in payment for work done. Efforts are being made to get the contractor back to site to complete the outstanding works.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Bekoe: Yes, Mr Speaker. The contractor that did Nankase to Dawa Road indeed has completed the works and markings, but between Adarkwa to Otwebediadua, and Ntukum has deteriorated because I think that the contractor did a first coat—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, what is your supplementary question?

Mr Bekoe: I would come to that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Ask the supplementary question.

Mr Bekoe: Mr Speaker, I would do so.

I can understand the Bole Bamboi matter but the people of Suhum, Gariba Zongo, Otwebediadua and Adarkwa also matter so if you can speed up the process so something can be done.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

4:56 p.m.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I would encourage my Colleague to stick to his Constituency and leave other constituency matters for those people to deal with.

Mr Speaker, indeed, I responded this way because, as he said, some of the roads he mentioned have been completed and are no longer under construction. So, my response was to the one that is under construction. Efforts are being made to get a contractor back to site to complete the remaining scope.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, do you have a further supplementary question?

Mr Bekoe: I thank him; I know he would deliver. Thank you very much. Hon Minister, I trust you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now, we would move to the Question numbered 375, standing in the name of Michael Okyere Baafi, Member of Parliament for New Juaben South and my very good friend.

Current Status of Mamfe-Koforidua-Bunso Road Construction

Mr Michael Baafi Okyere (NPP — New Juaben South): I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the current status of the construction on the Mamfe-Koforidua-Bunso Road.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, thank you.

The Mamfe-Koforidua-Bunso Road (73km) forms part of the N4 Highway from Tetteh Quarshie Interchange through Koforidua to Bunso Junction on the N6.

Current Programme

There is currently no periodic maintenance contract on this stretch. The Ghana Highway Authority (GHA) executed emergency sectional repair works between Mamfe to Koforidua (km 0 - 30) in 2024.

Currently, GHA has programmed the road for pothole patching under the 2025/2026 Routine Maintenance Works.

Future Programme

Engineering studies and cost estimates have been carried out on the road for consideration under the 2026 Budget upon the availability of funds.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any follow-up?

Mr Okyere: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Hon Minister, I just want to find out if it will be appropriate and convenient. The stretch from Okorase to Koforidua is a very important stretch that leads to Koforidua. Koforidua being the capital of the Region, I expect that if it will be in the interest of the whole country and—there should be a little construction or a rehabilitation on that stretch—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Go and lobby the Minister in his office.

Mr Okyere: No, I just want to find out if it may be necessary that the Minister can call for an urgent rehabilitation?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is why I am advising you to go and lobby the Minister in his office.

Mr Okyere: I will do that, but I am doing it through you here, on the floor of Parliament.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, I would take you to the Minister's office.

Mr Okyere: Mr Speaker, I still want him to answer that for me.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I think he has asked a legitimate and a fair question. I would work with the agencies to see if we can do further work in the section he has talked about. So, yes, we can do something about that.

Mr Okyere: Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this is also a constituency-specific Question, so let us move to the Question numbered 378 which is standing in the name of Mr Nelson Kofi Djabab, Member of Parliament for Krachi East.

Status of Work on the Asukawkaw-Kanease-Dormabin Road

Mr Nelson Kofi Djabab (NDC — Krachi East): I rise to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the status of work on the Asukawkaw-Kanease-Dormabin road.

Mr Agbodza: Asukawkaw – Kanease - Dormabin is a 24km feeder road located in the Krachi East Municipality of the Oti Region. It is an engineered gravel road in poor surface condition.

The Asukawkaw – Kanease - Dormabin feeder road was awarded under the contract titled “Bituminous Surface Dressing of Asukawkaw - Adumadum - Dormabin Ph.1 Feeder Road (km 0.0-12.3)”.

The contract was awarded on 11th April, 2018 for completion by 27th June, 2020. The overall progress of works is estimated at 40 per cent physical completion. The Contractor is currently on site and works are ongoing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Djabab: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

No further question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, this is also a Constituency-specific Question, so let us move to the Question numbered 415, standing in the name of Hon Kofi Amankwa-Manu, a Member of Parliament for Atwima Kwanwoma.

Return of Contractor to some Atwima Kwanwoma Constituency Roads

Mr Kofi Amankwa-Manu (NPP — Atwima Kwanwoma): I rise to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the contractor working on the following roads in the Atwima Kwanwoma Constituency will return to site: (i) Ohwimase – Trabuom (ii) Ahenema Kokobeng – Anwiankwanta, (iii) Brofoyedru – Foase, (iv) Trabuom – Nweneso, (iv) Ampeyo – Asaago.

Mr Agbodza: All the roads mentioned above by my Colleagues, this is the current programme.

Ohwimase – Trabuom Road

Background

The Ohwimase – Trabuom road is 10km long. It is located in the Atwima Kwanwoma constituency of the Ashanti region.

Current Programme

The road has been awarded under the contract titled ‘Upgrading of Kwadaso – Trabuom Road (15.20km)’.

The contract commenced on 5th September, 2019, for completion by 4th September, 2021 and was later revised to 4th March, 2025. The progress of work is at 85.1 per cent physical completion. However, the works have stalled due to delay in payment for work done. Efforts are being made to bring the contractor back to site to complete the outstanding works.

Ahenema Kokobeng – Anwiankwanta

Background

The road forms part of the National Route 10 (N10) which links the Central, Ashanti, Bono East, Northern and Upper East Regions. It is 20km long and located in the Atwima Kwanwoma Constituency of the Ashanti Region.

Current Programme

The road has been awarded under the contract titled ‘Dualization of Anwiankwanta – Ahenema Kokoben Road Project (Km 0.0 – 20.0)’.

It was awarded on 22nd April, 2024, for execution and completion in Twenty-Four (24) Calendar Months. The project commenced on 28th May, 2024 and was scheduled to be completed by 27th May, 2026. The progress currently is at 34 per cent completion. However, the works have stalled due to delay in payment for work done. Efforts are being made to bring the contractor back to site to complete the outstanding works.

Brofoyedru-Foase road

Background

The Brofoyedru-Foase Feeder Road is a 12.1km feeder road in the Atwima Kwanwoma district of the Ashanti region. It is an engineered road in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

The Brofoyedru-Foase feeder road was awarded under the contract titled “Upgrading of Access Roads to Trede District Hospital Feeder Road (27.33km)-Addendum No. 2: Partial Reconstruction of Brofoyedru-Foase (12.1km) and Access (10.49km)”.

The contract commenced on 7th May, 2024 for completion by 6th May, 2026. The overall progress of works is estimated at 29.7 per cent physical completion. The contractor is currently not on site and works have stalled due to delay in payment for work done. Efforts are being made to get the contractor back to site to complete the outstanding works.

Traboum – Nweneso

Background

The Traboum – Nweneso No. 1 Road serves as a link connecting the Kwadaso – Traboum road (R-134) and the Anwiankwanta – Adumasa road (R-105).

Current Programme

The Contract for “Rehabilitation of Trabuom - Nweneso No.1 Road (km 0.00 - km 16.00) and Trabuom Road (BY - PASS) - 0.90 km”. The contract commenced on 28th June, 2024, for completion by 27th June, 2026. The physical progress is currently at 19.6 per cent completion. However, the work has stalled due to delay in payment. Efforts are being made to bring the contractor back to site to complete the outstanding works.

5:06 p.m.

Ampeyo-Asaago

Background

The Ampeyo-Asaago road is a 2.6km earth road that connects the Ampeyo and Asaago communities in the Atwima Kwanwoma District of the Ashanti Region.

Current Programme

The Department of Urban Roads (DUR) adopted stage construction for the road; and awarded three (3) contracts for the construction of the road as follows:

- i. Drainage works along Asaago-Wood village Road (2.6km) - Lot 33
- ii. Drainage works along Ampeyo-Asaago Road (1.4km) - Lot 34
- iii. Graveling works on selected Roads in Atwima Kwanwoma (7.2km) - Lot 11

The contracts for the drainage works were awarded on 13th September 2024 for completion by 25th March 2025 while the contract for the graveling commenced 27th September 2025 for completion on 26th March 2025. The drainage works are at 75 per cent physical completion, while the graveling is at 27 per cent physical completion.

The Contractors are currently not on site due to delay in payment for work done and efforts are being made to get them back to site to complete all outstanding works.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Minister.

Any supplementary question?

Mr Amankwa-Manu: Mr Speaker, let me thank the Minister for his answers. But it has become obvious that the roads are being delayed because of delay in payment. I will plead with the Hon Minister if something can be done as quickly as possible because the roads are so horrible and the residents of Atwima-Kwanwoma are finding it very difficult. I am just pleading with the Hon Minister for something to be done.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, the Minister has heard you. This is a constituency-specific question. Question numbered 386 standing in the name of Mr Kwame Appiah Kodua, Member for Fanteakwa North.

Resumption of Construction Works on the Miaso-Ahomahomasu to Obooho Road

Mr Kwame Appiah Kodua (NPP — Fanteakwa North): Mr Speaker, I

beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the contractor on the Miaso-Ahomahomasu to Obooho road will return to site after halting construction some months ago.

Background

Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

The Miaso-Ahomahomasu-Obooho feeder road is captured in the Department of Feeder Roads (DFR) database as Miaso-Feyiase-Obuoho feeder road, which is 30.8km long. The road is located in the Fanteakwa North District of the Eastern Region. It is an engineered gravel road in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

The Miaso-Feyiase-Obuoho feeder road was awarded under the contract titled “Upgrading of Kwahu Tafo- Miaso feeder Road (km19.50-29.50) & Others and Miaso-Feyiase-Obuoho Feeder Road (30.8km)”.

The contract was awarded on 27th May, 2024 for completion by 19th February, 2026. The overall progress of works is estimated at 21.8 per cent physical completion. The Contractor is currently not on site and works have stalled due to delay in payment for work done. Efforts are being made to get the Contractor back to site to complete the outstanding works.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Kodua: Rightly so, Mr Speaker. While appreciating the answer given by the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways, I want to find out, because personally I believe in your stature and he has been an industry player as well. What practical steps are the Ministry taking to ensure that some funds will be released so that the contractor can go back to site to continue with the work? This is because the area is very critical so far as commercial activities in the Constituency are concerned. Thank you so much.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, naturally the easiest way to make sure that when we award contracts, we pay for it is to be prudent in the way we award the projects. Mr Speaker, the data on this project suggests that this project was originally awarded at GHC305 million on Road Fund. In less than a month, an addendum was added at GHC310 million making it a total of GHC317 million on Road Fund. Hon Colleagues, the total accruals of the Road Fund are just about GHC2 billion so if we award one project for GHC600 million on Road Fund, indeed we are going to find trouble paying for it.

Mr Speaker, that is outside of the fact that we currently owe contractors GHC7 billion for works done on Road Fund already which has not been paid for. So, prudence would have been the easiest way to make sure that when we award projects, we pay for it. This project did not even have commitment authorisation yet we awarded it for GHC617 million on Road Fund. So, the answer is prudence would have cured this.

Unfortunately, we were left with this to deal with it. Of course, going forward, President Mahama has just paid over GH¢5 billion already. No Government has ever paid that money at a particular time and we are going to pay a little bit more.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, just be focus on your answer.

Mr Agbodza: So, if the previous people were a bit diligent in the award of project knowing that the funds upon which you are awarding the project is meagre and yet we awarded too much projects, we would have been out of here but we will do whatever it is as a Government to ensure that once we award them we will make sure we raise the necessary funds and all those projects that have been awarded without commitment authorisation we intend to perfect the contract and make sure we regularise them for the contractors to have the comfort to continue and work in our communities. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member. Do you have any other question?

Mr Kodua: Thank you, Mr Speaker. The constituents of Fanteakwa North are waiting for the Minister to do something about the road. The narration will not solve the problem.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you should be guided in the way you speak. Kindly resume your seat.

Mr Kodua: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I am guided.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Kindly resume your seat.

We then move to Question numbered 399. Standing in the name of Daniel Dung Mahama, Hon Member for Talensi. You have the floor.

Plans for Construction of a New Bridge across the White Volta

Mr Daniel Dung Mahama (NDC — Talensi): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the plans of the Ministry to construct a new bridge across the White Volta, which links the North-East to the Upper East Region, considering the deplorable state of the current bridge and its impact on the proposed Pwalugu multipurpose dam.

Background

Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza: Mr Speaker, the Pwalugu Bridge is a strategic asset within the Walewale to Bolgatanga corridor. This bridge links North-East Region directly to the Upper East Region.

Current Programme

The construction of an alternative bridge across the White Volta which links North-East to Upper East through Mishuo has been awarded under the contract titled “Construction of Bridge over River White Volta along Mishuo – Woyema Road (210m) and 9.4Km Access Road’.

The contract commenced on 4th January 2021 for completion by 3rd January 2023 and was later revised to 5th November, 2025. The progress of works is estimated at 34.05 per cent physical completion.

The Contractor has slowed down works due to delay in payment for work done. Efforts are being made to get the Contractor to return to complete all outstanding works.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr D. D. Mahama: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I do not have any supplementary question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. We move to the last Question numbered 564, standing in the name of Prof Hamza Adam, Member of Parliament for Kumbungu.

Completion Date for Works on Some Feeder Roads in the Kumbungu Constituency

Prof Hamza Adam (NDC — Kumbungu): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the contractor will complete work on the following feeder roads: (i) Kumbungu – Gupanargu – Kochim (ii) Kumbungu – Limo (iii) Kumbungu – Zugu – Yipelgu – Satani (iv) Zugu – Zugudabogni – Kushibo.

Mr Kwame Governs Agbodza: Mr Speaker, these are the current programmes on all the roads mentioned by my Colleague.

5:16 p.m.

Kumbungu-Gupanargu-Kochim

Background

The first one is the Kumbungu – Gupanargu – Kochim feeder road is located in the Kumbungu District of the Northern Region. It is classified as a connector linking the Kumbungu District to the Tolon District. The road is an 8.8km partially engineered, earth road in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

The Kumbungu – Gupanargu – Kochim feeder road was awarded under the contract titled “Rehabilitation of Kumbungu-Gupanargu-Kochim, Kumbungu-Limo, Kumbungu-Zugu-Yipelgu-Satani, Zugu-Zugudabogni-Kushibo Feeder Roads (35km)”.

The contract commenced on 9th December, 2024 for completion by 9th June, 2026. The overall progress of works on the road is estimated at 60 per cent physical completion. The Contractor is currently on site and works are ongoing.

Kumbungu-Limo

Background

The Kumbungu – Limo feeder road is located in the Kumbungu District of the Northern Region. It is classified as an access linking Kumbungu to Limo. The road is a 7km partially engineered, earth road in poor surface condition.

Current Programme

The Kumbungu-Limo feeder road was awarded under the contract titled “Rehabilitation of Kumbungu-Gupanaguri-Kochim, Kumbungu-Limo, Kumbungu-Zugu-Yipelgu-Satani, Zugu-Zugudabogni-Kushibo Feeder Roads (35km)”. The contract commenced on 9th December 2024 for completion by 9th June, 2026. The overall progress of works on the road is estimated at 60 per cent physical completion. The Contractor is currently on site and works are ongoing.

Kumbungu-Zugu-Yipelgu-Satani

Background

The Kumbungu-Zugu-Yipelgu-Satani road is located in the Kumbungu District of the Northern Region. The road is 15km partially engineered gravel road.

Current Programme

Two separate contracts were awarded under project titles:

Emergency remedial works on Buipe – Kotito-Damango road (km 14.9 – 38.4), Construction of 1No. single 2m x 2m box culvert and 6No. 1/1200mm diameter pipe culverts”. Relocated to Savelugu – Sakpem & Sakpem – Santani Road (Km 0.8-6.6).

Emergency remedial works on Buipe – Kotito road (km 11.3 – 14.9), Construction of 1No. 1/900mm, 1 No.

2/900mm, 4No. 1/1200mm pipe culverts & 1No. 1/2m x 2m Box culverts” Relocated to Sakpem - Boggu Road.

The contracts commenced in May, 2019 for completion by March 2023. Works are substantially completed as per the original scope, which primarily is construction of culverts and filling of approaches.

Zugu-Zugudabogni-Kushibo

Background

The Zugu-Zugudabogni-Kushibo feeder road is located in the Kumbungu District of the Northern Region. It is classified as an access linking Kumbungu to Kushibo. The road is an 8.7km partially engineered gravel road in good surface condition.

Current Programme

The Zugu-Zugudabogni-Kushibo feeder road was awarded under the contract titled “Rehabilitation of Kumbungu-Gupanaguri-Kochim, Kumbungu-Limo, Kumbungu-Zugu-Yipelgu-Satani, Zugu-Zugudabogni-Kushibo Feeder Roads (35km)”.

The contract commenced on 9th December, 2024 for completion by 9th June, 2026. The overall progress of works on the road is estimated at 92 per cent physical completion. The Contractor is currently on site and works are ongoing.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary questions?

Prof Hamza Adam: Yes, Mr Speaker. Thank you very much, Hon Minister, for your effort and response.

The contractor is back to site and working. However, in your response, if you look at Kumbungu, Zugu, Yipelegu, Satani road, as indicated in your Answer, the road was relocated. However, it is the most damaged and most critical road which my people are looking for—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, what is your supplementary question?

Prof Hamza Adam: My question, Mr Speaker, is what steps would the Hon Minister take to ensure that Kumbungu, Zugu, Yipelgu, Satani road is awarded?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, indeed my Hon Colleague discussed the particular issue with me privately. It appears the road was awarded and a portion was relocated to another place. Meaning that on the contract database, it is assumed that particular place was part of the current programme. He raised it with me and I agree that we need to do something to bring that portion back. So, I will work with him to make sure that we work on the section that is currently not being worked on because of the relocation of a certain portion to another place.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Prof Hamza Adam: Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity. I am done.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Question time is ended. Let me thank the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways for attending upon the House always to respond to Questions. We are most grateful. We have taken notice of your presence in this House each time Questions are selected for you. Thank you very much

Yes, Hon Deputy Majority Leader?

Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I want to pray with you to alter the Order of Business and go on to Public Business and take the item numbered 17. The Hon Minister for Education is here to do the Scholarship Authority Bill at the Consideration Stage.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, at commencement of Public Business, the item numbered 17 — Ghana Scholarship Authority Bill under consideration.

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, I was thinking that you would check with me as well to know—I mean, although he has hinted me, I thought that the procedure is—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I thought you have always been saying that it is at the discretion of the Speaker.

Mr Shaib: Yes, without doubt. But, I mean, we are working—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: When I said that in line with the natural justice, I wanted to hear from both Sides, but the indication was that it is at my discretion.

Mr Shaib: Yes, so I was going to quote you—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Even today, it has been said.

Mr Shaib: But, Mr Speaker, you said in line with natural justice, and there are two—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, that is my approach. But the indication was that, I have the discretion, so nobody can raise an issue. But having raised the issue, let me listen to you.

Mr Shaib: Very well, Mr Speaker. We are not opposed. I just thought that in the natural course of things you would have sought mine.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE
Ghana Scholarship Authority Bill,
2025

[Resumption of Consideration from 29/10/2025]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Ghana Scholarship Authority Bill under consideration.

Hon Members, we are just cross-checking to see where we ended the last time. Hon Minister, can you guide us?

Is it clause 31? I know clauses 4 and 5 have been deferred.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Rightly so, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, we ended on clause 31.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: If we can continue from clause 31, then later on, we can look at clauses 4 and 5. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The rules are relaxed at the Consideration Stage. The Clerks-at-the-Table can cross-check that information for us. But let us quickly move to take clause 31. Yes, Chairman of the Committee.

Clause 31 — Refusal to return to the country after completion of programme

Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I want to seek your leave. The Chairman of the Committee is out of the jurisdiction so I want to apply for a Member of the Committee, Mr Edem Agbana, to stand in for him.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. I am informed that some microphones are not still working.

Yes, are you the Vice-Chairman, or a member of the Committee?

Mr Agbana: Mr Speaker, I am a member of the Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Clause 31.

Mr Edem Agbana on behalf of Mr Peter Kwasi Nortsu-Kotoe: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, clause 31 *delete* and *insert* the following.

- (1) “A person who benefits from a scholarship under this Act to study outside the country shall, subject to the terms and conditions determined by the Authority, return to serve the country after completion of the programme of study.”
- (2) A person who contravenes subsection (1) shall pay to the Authority
 - a. a refund of the total amount of the scholarship awarded to the person: and
 - b. interest on the total amount of the scholarship at the prevailing Bank of Ghana rate.
- (3) Where a person fails to pay the penalty specified under subsection (2), the Authority shall recover the total amount of the scholarship and the applicable interest as a civil debt at a rate of twice the total amount of the scholarship and the interest on the total amount.”

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 31 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

5.26 p.m.

Clause 32—Regulations

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Nyindam?

Mr Matthew Nyindam: Mr Speaker, I thought we were dealing with a Bill and not Question time—*[Laughter]*—so if you can be patient with us—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Do you have a proposed amendment to clause 32?

Mr Nyindam: I do.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What is your proposed amendment?

Mr Nyindam: It has been amended but I wanted to find out from the Minister if it is not appropriate for us to give a timeframe, maybe a period of two, three or five years. But if we just say that after completion, the person should come back and serve the country, it is too open. I am wondering if we could give a timeframe.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Which clause are you talking about?

Mr Nyindam: Mr Speaker, we are talking about clause 31(1).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We have put the question on clause 31, so come at Second Consideration. We are now at clause 32

Mr Nyindam: Mr Speaker, let us be flexible.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, clause 32. Any amendment?

Mr Agbana: Mr Speaker, there is no proposed amendment.

Clause 32 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we need to learn the rudiments of the game. If a question is put and carried, you can only come to that question by Second Consideration, except by leave of the Speaker. It is not automatic, so to say that this is not Question time and the Speaker should be flexible, I consider it unguided. The Rules are clear: when questions are put and the amendment is carried, you can only come back to that amendment by leave of the Speaker or at Second Consideration. You cannot be seeking the leave of the Speaker by asking the Speaker to be flexible.

Yes, Hon Nyindam?

Mr Nyindam: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I am guided.

The only reason I made that statement was because I was on my feet, but unfortunately, I did not catch your eye. That is why I thought that as a Friend —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, the right thing you should have done was draw my attention by saying that,

“Mr Speaker, although you have put a question on clause 31, may I have your leave to take you back to clause 31?”

And if the leave is granted, you can do that or you take note and come back at Second Consideration.

Mr Nyindam: Mr Speaker, I am guided. Thank you very much.

Clause 33 — Interpretation

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Clause 33, Chairman of the Committee.

Mr Agbana: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, Interpretation of “Government Scholarship”, line 2, after “is”, *delete* “award”, and *insert* “awarded”, and in line 2, after “corporation”, *delete* “or a foreign sponsor” and *insert* “bilateral partner or multilateral partner”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What will be the new rendition?

Mr Agbana: Mr Speaker, the new rendition will be,

“In this Act, unless the context otherwise requires, ‘Government Scholarship’ includes a bursary and a grant that is awarded by the Government, a public corporation or a bilateral partner or multilateral partner”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposed amendment is for the consideration of the House.

Mr John Darko: Mr Speaker, I recommend that instead of putting “bilateral partner or multilateral partner”, we make it “bilateral and multilateral partner”.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, if I have your indulgence, in the second line after “Government Scholarship”, I agree with the Committee to *delete* “award” and *insert* “awarded” for the elegance of construction.

At the Committee level, what is referred to as a bilateral partner is for instance, I met with the Ambassador of the United Arab Emirates today, who is saying that they may be able to award scholarships to up to 20 persons. That would be a bilateral agreement between Ghana and the United Arab Emirates. There may be instances where it could be between Ghana and Morocco, Spain, or France that may want to award a scholarship. These are the cases for bilateral partnerships, but for multilateral, I am not too sure.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, why do you want it to be conjunctive instead of disjunctive?

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, the Committee proposed “bilateral partner and multilateral partner”—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, the proposal here is “bilateral partner or multilateral partner”, look at page 9.

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, so it should be “bilateral partner and multilateral partner”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is why I am asking why you want it to be conjunctive when the rendition wants it to be disjunctive. Because the use of “or” and “and” in interpretation is different. “Or” is interpreted disjunctively, and “and” is interpreted conjunctively.

Now, the sponsors of the Bill want it to be disjunctive; however, you are proposing for it to be conjunctive, and I am asking why.

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, we can have the two. So, we are defining government partnerships.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, so it means that it can either be bilateral or multilateral. But you want it to be both, and that is why I am asking why you want it to be so.

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, there is nothing wrong with having both.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: If you say “and”, then it means that both must happen at the same time, but they are using “or”.

Yes, Dr Mahama?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Mr Speaker, I thought the Hon Member wanted us to make it a bit more elegant by not saying “bilateral partner or multilateral partner”. I thought he wanted us to *delete* the first partner and keep the other; that was the understanding I had. But if that is not the understanding, I think that we should leave it as “or” because if we make it a

conjunctive, then it means that it must be both bilateral and multilateral before they would be qualified under the definition.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, that would be more problematic.

Dr Mahama: But if we leave it as “or”, either bilateral or multilateral is qualified. I think that we can keep it as it is. But I do not know whether or not his proposal is for us to make it a “bilateral or multilateral partner”, because that was the first understanding I had. He is saying that, for the elegance of it, let us *delete* the first partner and just say “bilateral or multilateral partner”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: If we take out one partner, it can be problematic because we are referring to “bilateral partner or multilateral partner”.

Hon Member, I think the rendition should stay the way as proposed.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

6:11 p.m.

Mr Agbana on behalf of Chairman of the Committee: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, clause 33, add the following new definition:

“Ghana Education Trust Fund” means the Ghana Education Trust Fund established under section 1 of the Ghana Education Trust Fund Act, 2000 (Act 581);”

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr Agbana on behalf of the Chairman of the Committee: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, clause 33 vii, add the following new definition:

“Student Loan Trust Fund” means the Student Loan Trust Fund established under the Student Loan Trust Act, 2011 (Act 820).”

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 33 as amended ordered to start part of the Bill.

Clause 34 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minister for Education. Clauses 4 and 5 have been deferred.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, if you can indulge me, we can take Clause 4. Mr Speaker, you may recall, when this Bill was introduced in this House, the civil society groups in education expressed concern about representation on the governing authority. Notably, there were calls for the National Union of Ghana Students to have a representative. The other was for civil society groups in education to have a representative. Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister for Gender, Children and Social Protection made a strong case in respect of Clause 4 (1) (f), ‘three other persons nominated by the President’. We discussed with the Chairman of the

Committee that it will now read, “two other persons nominated by the President, at least one of whom is a woman”.

If I can yield to the Committee to take it, but there is no problem. We reached out to civil society, they made their recommendations to the Committee that they wanted an improvement on the governing authority.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, what we want to do is to ensure that the concern raised by the civil society is carried on board. That is why we are deferring these two clauses to be considered today. Tomorrow, we will then take it on the Floor.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I have no problem.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I assure you that once we are done with Clause 4 and 5, we will take it tomorrow. We would look at the Long Title and then do the needful.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I am guided.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We have come to the end of the Consideration Stage for today.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, have you thought through your decision on item 10 (a), or do you want us to still stand that down until tomorrow?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, we will stand it down for tomorrow.

Mr Ayariga: Then Mr Speaker, I think we can move to Statements.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, let us move to the item numbered 8. We have two Statements standing in the name of Ms Rita Naa Odoley Sowah, Hon Member of Parliament for Dadekotopon, and Ms Laurette Korkor Asante, Hon Member of Parliament for Atiwa West.

We will start with the Statement at 8 (a) standing in the name of Ms Rita Naa Odoley Sowah, Hon Member for Dadekotopon.

5:46 p.m.

STATEMENT

Honouring the Pan-African Vision and Revolutionary Journey of Yasmine Affoué Diawara

Ms Rita Naa Odoley Sowah (NDC — Dadekotopon): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to make this Statement before this respected House. I rise with deep admiration and conviction to draw the attention of this honourable House to an extraordinary continental movement led by a determined daughter of Africa, Diawara Affoué Yasmine, a 34-year-old cyclist, activist and visionary from Côte d’Ivoire.

She launched a bold transcontinental journey titled WIRI, meaning “Where Innovation Rises”, cycling from

Korhogo in northern Côte d'Ivoire through own country Ghana and onwards to Cape Town, South Africa. She successfully completed the journey after crossing 11 African countries in total. It was far more than a physical expedition, it became a campaign of consciousness, a travelling manifesto of resilience and reform. Her journey stood as a declaration without slogans and an act of advocacy in motion.

Mr Speaker, in the Dioula or Malinké language, *Wiri* means “to stand”. This was a charge to this generation to rise with clarity, creativity and courage. Yasmine’s expedition challenged the continent to believe in itself, ideas, people and power to disrupt entrenched systems.

Mr Speaker, from remote villages to bustling capitals, she rode with purpose, not for fame, not for leisure, but to mobilise Africa’s most sacred asset, its youth. A youth population that continues to expand by 20 million each year, yet too often finds itself at the mercy of global financial amnesty and institutional inertia. Through this mission, she called attention to the opportunities before us and the urgent reforms required to seize them.

Mr Speaker, she rides for economic justice, for gender equity and for a truly sustainable Africa. An Africa built on integrity, heritage and the aspirations of its own people. Her initiative, Agenda Africa, dares to confront the structural inequities in the global financial order. It insists on climate reparations grounded in justice, not debts, and it affirms our

continent's ability to mobilise our own resources through transparent governance, fair tax systems and inclusive economic models.

These ideals were echoed and reinforced at the 2025 African Parliamentary Network on Illicit Financial Flows and Taxation (APNIFFT) Continental Conference, held in Johannesburg this October, where African parliamentarians, civil society leaders and policy experts marked a decade of action against illicit financial flows. Mr Speaker, the conference called for renewed legislative commitments to fiscal transparency, equitable tax systems and citizen-centred governance. It emphasised the need for Africa-led solutions to global financial injustices, aligning perfectly with the ethos of WIRI.

Through WIRI, Ms Diawara also gave life to several of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG), including SDG 4 - Quality Education, SDG 5 - Gender Equality, SDG 8 - Decent Work and Economic Growth, SDG 9 - Innovation and Infrastructure, SDG 13 - Climate Action and SDG 16 - Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions.

In each country, she stopped to spotlight young changemakers, particularly women who were spearheading grassroots solutions in education, technology, environmental preservation and civic participation. Mr Speaker, this mission aligned perfectly with the sustained advocacy within this Parliament and throughout our continent for affirmative action. Inclusive governance and

women's leadership are not secondary demands; they are fundamental prerequisites for sustainable development. Yasmine Diawara's work reflected the spirit of transformative feminism where women are not simply invited to participate but entrusted to design, lead and implement change, from the front lines. She reminded us that women's leadership is central to sustainable development. Progress must be inclusive. A society that sidelines its women and youth cannot truly move forward.

Ghana indeed welcomed her with warmth and pride. We offered our institutional and moral support to her campaign, ensuring that our country would be remembered not merely as a point she passed but as a nation that shared the burden, believed in the message and amplified the mission. Yasmine's path connected more than capitals—it united hearts, elevated voices and ignited minds. It told every African girl that leadership does not always wear a suit. Sometimes she wears cycling gear and carries hope across deserts and borders.

Let it now be permanently recorded that this Parliament recognised the courage and clarity of Yasmine Diawara. She did not wait for doors to open; she forged new ones with every paddle stroke. In doing so, she inspired us all, especially our daughters, to rise boldly and claim their rightful place in shaping Africa's future. Thank you, Mr Speaker, for this opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Statement ably made. It is for your contribution.

Prof Hamza Adam (NDC — Kumbungu): Thank you so much for the opportunity, Mr Speaker. Let me thank Hon Rita Odoley Sowah for the detailed submission. Mr Speaker, I am very much impressed about the task that has been taken up by our dear sister. She has proven that what men can do, women can do that better. Many times, we hear about men cycling, walking and all that, but we have not heard much about that from women, so her initiative will go into the record as one of the heroes that we have registered from the female gender.

One very touching aspect of the submission that I have picked up has to do with the gender. Our sister is mobilising resources, to support rural communities, to get bicycles. In fact, if one happens to walk in some of the deprived communities, some of the students, including girls, walk up to five or six kilometres on foot trying to go to school. Our Hon Minister for Education started something in Tamale which was so good. He started buying bicycles for school children randomly because a lot of them go through struggles. If a child, going to school on a particular day is lucky and chances upon him, he would just tell the child to go somewhere and pick a bicycle. That was the generosity that he exhibited in trying to support that.

So, the initiative by our dear sister, particularly mobilising bicycles to support girls in rural areas, will go a very long way to support their effort to pursue education. On this note, I would not want to talk too much.

I once again would thank the maker of the Statement for that insightful presentation. I thank you for the opportunity.

5:56 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Kabiru?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama (NPP — Walewale): Mr Speaker, I think that we probably have a lot to do, so I would be brief. Our Sister draws our attention to the rule Yasmine Diawara makes as a young person. I would comment on the things that she was advocating for.

First and foremost, in her campaign; journey over 8,000 kilometres across 11 African countries, she is advocating against, one, illicit financial flows. The data on illicit financial flows has been staggering. Recently, we had an opportunity as Finance Committee to have an engagement on this matter. The data suggests that Ghana, as a country lost about US\$1.6 billion between the year 2019 and 2020 to unaccounted gold exports, which is part of the broader illicit financial flows. Mr Speaker, not only that, between 2002 and 2011, about US\$14.33 billion were lost to trade misinvoicing. This speaks to the importance of the issue that Ms Diawara was campaigning for.

Aside that, she is standing for tax fairness. Taxation is at the heart of fiscal policy, and if a young lady of 34 years is drawing global attention to issues of tax fairness, you would understand why we need it. Mr Speaker, we complain that our tax system is retrogressive, where the

poor is made to bear the burden of taxation at the expense of the rich when they should be paying more for the purpose of shared responsibility.

Last but not the least is youth employment. These are all important issues that we would have to acknowledge that her adventure, advocacy, and campaign of cycling over 8,000 km across 11 countries is something that we would need to actually encourage.

Mr Speaker, my last issue also draws our attention to the impact of the youth in change-making; youth as agents of change. The young lady is only 34 years old, and she has made huge impact, attracting attention from institutions such as Tax Justice Network Africa (TJNA). This is an important institution that is so much careful about illicit financial flows. For a young person to embark on a campaign that would attract the attention of institutions like Africa Agenda is something worth commending.

Mr Speaker, just yesterday, in New York, a young gentleman, Zohran Kwame Mamdani, also made history as a young person in changing the paradigm with which politics is done in the United States by actually standing against political dynasty for a long time. As a young person, many people thought he could not do that. But yesterday, he took the world by storm and won decisively against all the odds. So, this speaks to the impact young people can make and the ability for young people to influence.

Mr Speaker, in conclusion, I want to note that we would have to look at the issue of Sustainability Development Goals (SDGs). I think that as a House, this young lady should not only be drawing our attention, but we must also be an example of the initiative she is taking. I am happy that the African Parliamentary Network on Illicit Financial Flows and Taxation (APNIFFT) is collaborating and receiving her in their deliberation. I am sure that once we have such, we should encourage them. I want to say congratulations to Ms Diawara for this initiative. The people of Ghana and Africa as a whole are so proud of her achievement, and for her contribution to the development of Africa.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let me take the Hon Member at the back.

Mr Haruna Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, let me thank you for the opportunity to contribute to the Statement ably made by Ms Rita Naa Odoley Sowah, and to commend her for bringing matters of economic justice, gender and equity in Africa, and to join her in celebrating Yasmine Diawara for what she stands for.

Mr Speaker, she states that she is not doing this for fame nor for leisure, but to mobilise Africa's most sacred asset; its youth. That is succinct. Africa today has a youthful population of about 400 million between the ages of 15 and 35. Ghana itself has a growing youthful

population of 11.7 million, estimated to reach 17.7 million by the year 2050.

Mr Speaker, in Ghana, our youth between the ages of 15 and 35, represents 38.2 per cent of the population. What that provides is that we should invest more in education, particularly for that youthful age. Successive governments have done that and are doing that. But part of the challenge is—I am just commenting on the SDG of quality education.

In Ghana, at all levels of education, quality education is delivered. But the concern is the disparities in the provision of quality education between urban and rural areas, and between public and private schools. More quality in the private schools and less in the public schools; more quality in urban institutions and less in the rural areas. We need to correct that. For instance, in the recent school placement which happened following the Basic Education Certificate Examination (BECE), there are no category A schools in the North East, Savannah Region, Oti and Western North Regions. Mr Speaker, we have to be deliberate about it if young people in those areas are to be assured of access to senior high school education.

Mr Speaker, finally, manifestos win elections, but to change a country is development plan. We must learn as a country to align our budget to the implementation of defined national development plans. Ghana needs one. What successive governments in the last decade have done is that every two years, they come and lay the national development plans before here. I saw

Prof Gyan-Baffour lay one; I saw Mr Seth Terkper lay one; I saw Mr Ken Ofori-Atta lay one; and Dr Ato Forson would soon lay one. But, after the laying, are our Budgets responsive to the pursuit of those development plans?

Mr Speaker, I end it here, by commending the maker of the Statement. She could not have asked for a more poignant point than transparency in governance, particularly fair taxes. This is to the world; the tax havens are neither in Ghana nor Africa where you hear—Even looted money, when people steal, they go and hide them far away abroad.

6:06 p.m.

That is what we must avoid. He takes the money, then in the name of a shell company, takes it to a country abroad. We need a fair tax system, but it must begin with multilateral corporations on the moneys they are making from Africa. How come that mining, even cocoa, forgive me but Europe may be profiting more from Ghana's cocoa than Africa may be profiting from its cocoa. That is not acceptable. We need to change the narrative.

Mr Speaker, once again, we want to commend the Hon Deputy Minister and pray that all of us will make a contribution to better gender equity to build a truly sustainable Africa. But for Africa to achieve this, it needs investment in infrastructure and education. Thankfully in Ghana, more girls are going to school now than it used to be. If you look at the population of young girls who have been admitted to secondary school, it is an encouraging number. I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Minister.

Dr Mohammed Amin Adam (NPP — Karaga): Thank you, Mr Speaker. Let me also express my profound gratitude to the maker of the Statement, and in particular to commend Ms Diawara for the campaign, particularly on the matter of illicit financial flows, which continues to be a problem, not just for developing countries, but even for the developed countries and we must muster the courage and mobilise all the resources that we can to combat illicit financial flow.

Illicit financial flow deepens poverty levels in developing countries because it deprives us of resources that we could apply to education, provision of health services, and also towards the general development of our country. There are areas where illicit financial flows are prominent. The extractive industry is one such area. This area of development is very opaque, and because of that, illicit financial flows are finding their way deeply into extractive industries in any country. Ghana is no exception. I understand that Ghana loses almost US\$40 million every year through illicit financial flows from the extractive industries alone. If we were to add what we lose from other industries, that could be colossal sums of money that we are losing to illicit financial flows.

Mr Speaker, some of the practices through which this occurs are money laundering, tax avoidance schemes, under-invoicing, transfer pricing, among others. Fortunately for us, Ghana has some provisions in the Income Tax Act,

2015 (Act 896) to address this. However, these are not far-reaching enough. There are still weaknesses and gaps in our legal frameworks towards addressing illicit financial flows. In fact, last year, the current Minister for Finance and I were planning to write a book on illicit financial flows. Unfortunately, we could not do that. Now that he is Minister for Finance, I hope this House will support him when he brings Bills or amendments towards strengthening the legal provisions towards addressing illicit financial flows so that we can have a regime that is tight enough to ensure that we conserve these resources that we are losing out to support the general development of our country. Mr Speaker, there are different ways of addressing this.

First, mandatory contract disclosure is one. We have to ensure that all contracts that are signed within the extractive industry are disclosed so that we will know beneficial owners, all the stakeholders involved in those businesses, and we will be able to track the money that goes to the beneficial owners. If we can do this, I am very confident that we will reduce illicit financial flows through contract opacity.

The second is capacity building. Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA) is implementing the tax provisions towards illicit financial flows, but I can tell you that they have technical challenges, and therefore, Government will have to resource GRA to provide the technical capacity they need to be able to administer the tax provisions that are targeting illicit financial flows.

Also, international collaboration is important. We cannot do this alone. We need to be able to sign on to international conventions that are targeting money laundering and illicit financial flows. Ghana is already a member of the Financial Action Tax Force on money laundering, and I believe this House will help by making the necessary laws that will enhance the implementation of the regulations under the Financial Action Tax Force because they will all go a long way, not just to help the international space, but also our country and developing countries, in particular, towards conserving the resources that we are losing out to support the development efforts of our countries.

With these few words, let me once again thank the maker of the Statement for bringing this to the fore of this House. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I am inclined to bring Statement time to an end. We are supposed to take a second Statement, but I am reliably informed the maker of the Statement is not readily available, so we will bring Statement time to an end. Accordingly, Statement time is ended.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I do not know if this has been discussed already, but I think the Hon Member is supposed to make a statement on H.E. Nana Konadu Agyeman-Rawlings' demise.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I have admitted that particular Statement to the Clerk, and it is supposed to be

programmed for that the Clerks-at-the-Table to make copies available by placing it on the console so that Hon Members would then be aware of the Statement before it is taken on the floor.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I think I can just see it on the console here, which means that it is on every Member's console as well.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Then, why is it that the Statement programmed for today are in two-fold, 8 (a) and (b)?

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I would have thought that this is a commemorative –

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, a commemorative Statement can be taken tomorrow.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, it is in your hands.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, we have not sat for more than five hours.

Dr Mahama: Mr Speaker, I think that if our Senior would be minded, tomorrow would be a good start for such a Statement, mindful of the fact that we are just seeing it on the console, and her Statement should get some comments. I know the content of her Statements are

usually thought-provoking, and I would plead that if we can take it tomorrow, it will be very good, Mr Speaker.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Thank you, Mr Speaker. Fair enough, I think we can do that tomorrow when we are fresh.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. Yes, we have not done more than five hours, so let us do the needful.

Mr Ricketts-Hagan): Mr Speaker, we have not done five hours. I beg to move that the House be adjourned to tomorrow at 2:00 p.m. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Motion moved for adjournment.

Any seconder?

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, I second the Motion.

I was being advised by my available Leader to pray for continuation of Business, but I know there is no Business, so we will have to second.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 6:15 p.m. till Friday, 7th November, 2025 at 2:00 p.m.

